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AGENDA**

EBS/09/191

December 1, 2009

To: Members of the Executive Board

From: The Acting Secretary

Subject: **Democratic Republic of the Congo—Staff Report for the 2009 Article IV Consultation, Request for a Three-Year Arrangement Under the Poverty Reduction and Growth Facility, and Request for Additional Interim Assistance Under the Enhanced Initiative for Heavily Indebted Poor Countries**

Attached for consideration by the Executive Directors is a paper on the staff report for the 2009 Article IV consultation with the Democratic Republic of the Congo, its request for a three-year arrangement under the Poverty Reduction and Growth Facility, and its request for additional interim assistance under the enhanced Initiative for Heavily Indebted Poor Countries, which will be brought to the agenda for discussion on **a date to be announced**. Draft decisions appear on pages 28 and 29. At the time of circulation of this paper to the Board, the Secretary's Department has received a communication from the authorities of the Democratic Republic of the Congo indicating that they consent to the Fund's publication of this paper.

Questions may be referred to Mr. Ames (ext. 34076), Mr. Farah (ext. 34256), and Ms. Bovha-Padilla (ext. 38917) in AFR.

Unless the Documents Section (ext. 36760) is otherwise notified, the document will be transmitted, in accordance with the procedures approved by the Executive Board and with the appropriate deletions, to the WTO Secretariat on Wednesday, December 9, 2009; and to the African Development Bank, the Common Market for Eastern and Southern Africa, and the European Commission, following its consideration by the Executive Board.

This document, together with a supplement providing an informational annex, will shortly be posted on the extranet, a secure website for Executive Directors and member country authorities. The supplement, which is not being distributed in hard copy, will also be available in the Institutional Repository; a link can be found in the daily list (<http://www-int.imf.org/depts/sec/services/eb/dailydocumentsfull.htm>) for the issuance date shown above.

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DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC OF THE CONGO

Staff Report for the 2009 Article IV Consultation, Request for a Three-Year Arrangement Under the Poverty Reduction and Growth Facility, and Request for Additional Interim Assistance Under the Enhanced Initiative for Heavily Indebted Poor Countries

Prepared by the African Department

(In consultation with other departments)

Approved by Mark Plant and Dominique Desruelle

November 30, 2009

Mission dates: March 16–31; April 22–28; August 10–18; and October 27–November 10, 2009

Team: Messrs. Ames (head), Ben Ltaifa, and Farah, and Ms. Bovha-Padilla (all AFR) and Messrs. Callegari (FAD), Hostland (SPR), and Jahjah (Resident Representative). The team coordinated closely with the local World Bank office.

Context: Growth in 2008 was strong, but was weakened by the onset of the global financial crisis during the second half of the year that resulted in a deterioration of the country's terms of trade and large job losses in the mining sector. The escalation of the conflict in the eastern provinces, along with weaknesses in public financial management, resulted in large spending overruns during the fourth quarter of 2008, which placed pressure on the exchange rate and inflation through early 2009. The constitutionally mandated fiscal decentralization policy created further challenges during the year given weak institutional capacity at both the central and provincial levels. Macroeconomic policies for the rest of 2009 and 2010 aim at reducing inflation while mitigating the impact of the global financial sector on the economy.

Article IV consultation: Discussions focused on policies and reforms that (i) foster sustained and higher economic growth; (ii) enhance external sustainability; and (iii) strengthen institutional capacity for economic management.

Poverty Reduction and Growth Facility (PRGF): The authorities are requesting a new three-year arrangement under the PRGF in an amount of SDR 346.45 million (65 percent of quota) and additional interim assistance under the enhanced Heavily Indebted Poor Countries (HIPC) Initiative.

IMF relations: The last Article IV consultation took place on September 5, 2007, and since then staff have been monitoring the authorities' economic program through a series of staff monitored programs (SMPs). The previous PRGF arrangement (SDR 580 million; 109 percent of quota) was almost fully drawn (SDR 553.47 million) before it expired in March 2006 without completing the sixth review owing to policy slippages in the lead-up to the first democratic elections in four decades. The Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC) reached the decision point of the enhanced HIPC Initiative in July 2003.

Exchange rate regime: The DRC's exchange rate regime is classified as a free float. It has accepted the obligations under Article VIII, section 2, 3, and 4 of the Fund's Articles of Agreement, but maintains an exchange restriction and a multiple currency practice.

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ACRONYMS

AfDB	African Development Bank
AFRITAC	African Regional Technical Assistance Centers
ANAPI	National Investment Promotion Agency
BCC	Central Bank of the Congo
BTR	Central bank bills
CEEAC	Economic Community of Central African States
CIRR	Commercial interest reference rate
DRC	Democratic Republic of the Congo
DGRAD	Directorate of Administrative and State Revenue
DSA	Debt Sustainability Analysis
HIPC	Heavily Indebted Poor Countries
FDI	Foreign direct investment
I-PRGS	Interim Poverty Reduction and Growth Strategy
JSAN	Joint Staff Advisory Note
MCM	Monetary and Capital Markets Department
MDRI	Multilateral Debt Relief Initiative
MEFP	Memorandum of Economic and Financial Policies
NCG	Net credit to government
NDA	Net domestic assets
NEER	Nominal effective exchange rate
NFA	Net foreign assets
OCC	Congolese Office of Controls
OFIDA	Custom and Excise Collection Agency
OHADA	Organization for the Harmonization of Business Law in Africa
PAP	Priority Action Plan
PEG	Government Economic Program
PFM	Public financial management
PRGF	Poverty Reduction and Growth Facility
PRGS	Poverty Reduction and Growth Strategy
PRS-NSC	Poverty Reduction Strategy National Steering Commission
PRSP	Poverty Reduction Strategy Paper
PV	Present value
RAC-ESF	Rapid Access Component of the Exogenous Shocks Facility
REER	Real effective exchange rate
SADC	Southern African Development Community
SB	Structural benchmark
SCCA	Sino-Congolese Cooperation Agreement
SMP	Staff Monitored Program
TA	Technical assistance
TMU	Memorandum of Technical Understanding
VAT	Value added tax

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Recent developments. A sharp decline in world commodity prices in late 2008 slowed economic activity in 2009, while the escalation of conflict in the eastern provinces led to higher security spending, increased government borrowing from the central bank, and an upsurge in inflation and depreciation of the exchange rate during the first quarter of 2009. Lower government borrowing from the central bank and tight monetary policy during the first half of 2009 helped reduce inflation and stabilize the exchange rate. However, inflation increased and the exchange rate depreciated during the third quarter of 2009 reflecting excess liquidity in the economy largely due to central bank lending to distressed banks and failure to anticipate and mop up liquidity injections by the government. The DRC's debt situation remains unsustainable absent substantial debt relief.

Article IV Consultation. The discussions focused on fostering sustained and high economic growth, enhancing external sustainability, and strengthening institutional capacity for economic management. Key themes included:

- **Enhancing macroeconomic stability.** Fiscal policy should be geared to avoiding government recourse to central bank financing to alleviate the burden on monetary policy for achieving the inflation objective. Central bank reorganization, restructuring and recapitalization is key to enhancing its independence and capacity to conduct monetary policy. The free floating exchange rate regime is appropriate given the economy's susceptibility to exogenous shocks.
- **Increasing fiscal space.** The challenge is to mobilize domestic revenue and strengthen public financial management (PFM) in support of priority expenditure, including reconstruction. This requires bold reforms to modernize and consolidate tax administration, streamline exemptions, and simplify the tax system. Strengthening PFM, including at the provincial level given the decentralization policy, will also help improve expenditure allocation and mobilize development aid.
- **Improving the business climate.** The authorities need to press ahead with reforms to reduce the cost of doing business, with emphasis on restructuring public enterprises that provide growth critical services and on simplifying procedures for operating a business.
- **Strengthening institutional capacity.** The authorities need to strengthen policy coordination within government, including through the merging of the ministries in charge of finance and budget. Improving socioeconomic statistics is also critical for monitoring and assessing the effectiveness of policies and reforms.

New program. The authorities are requesting a three-year PRGF arrangement to support the implementation of their poverty reduction and growth strategy (PRGS) and additional interim HIPC assistance in the amount of SDR 45.66 million. The program aims to enhance macroeconomic stability, create fiscal space for priority spending, and accelerate structural reforms.

Program risks. The economy is vulnerable to exogenous shocks and the lingering conflict. Weak institutional capacity could also adversely affect program implementation. These risks could be lowered by increased donor financial and technical assistance and by the ongoing peace efforts to pacify the eastern provinces.

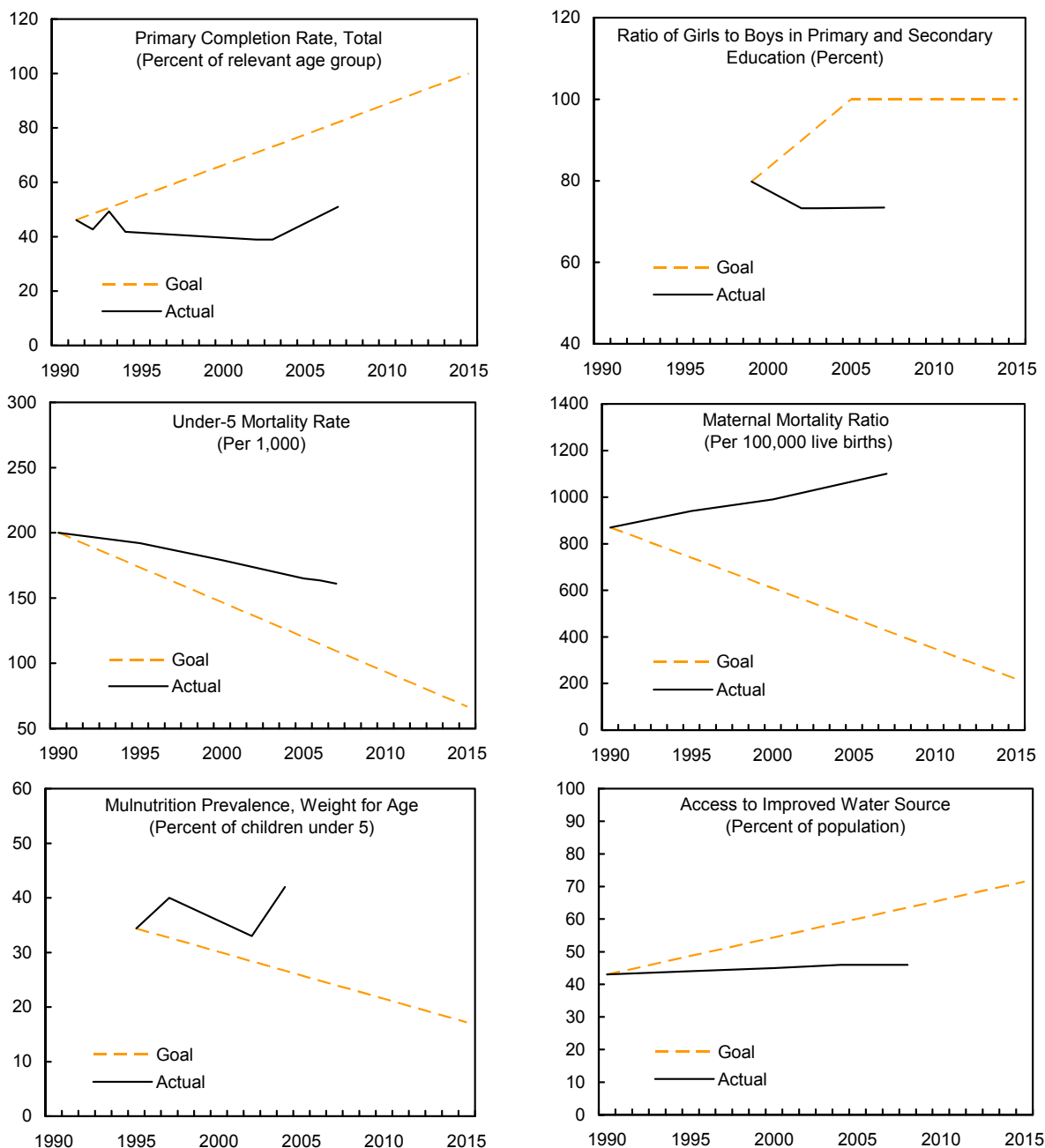
I. BACKGROUND AND CONTEXT

1. **Socioeconomic conditions in the DRC remain dire following a decade long conflict.** The human cost and destruction of the country's social and economic infrastructure were enormous. As a result, although rich in natural resources, the country's per capita income and human development indicators remain amongst the lowest in Africa (Figure 1).
2. **The return of peace to most of the country in 2003 paved the way for political and economic stability.** During 2003–06, the transitional government implemented prudent macroeconomic policies, restored confidence, brought hyperinflation under control, and laid the foundation for high levels of growth (Figure 2). This facilitated the installation of the new democratically elected government in March 2006.
3. **The country's dilapidated infrastructure constitutes one of the principal impediments to economic growth, private sector development, and poverty reduction.** Given the huge infrastructure development needs and limited concessional resources available from traditional development partners, the authorities are pursuing nontraditional modes of financing to fill the gap, including resource-backed infrastructure development financing (Box 1).
4. **The security situation in the eastern provinces remains fragile despite recent peacekeeping efforts.** Attacks by armed militants continue to destabilize the eastern provinces. In 2008 and early 2009, this resulted in urgent spending requests outside the expenditure chain that placed pressure on scarce budgetary resources. In March 2009, the government and key rebel groups signed an agreement to integrate combatants into the national army. Disarmament and reintegration remains a key challenge with important budgetary implications.
5. **The constitutionally mandated decentralization policy also poses significant budgetary and implementation challenges.** The authorities are committed to transferring 40 percent of government revenues to the provinces, along with the responsibility for implementing social sector programs. Given existing constraints, however, they have decided to slow down the pace of implementation while strengthening capacity in PFM and project implementation at the provincial level.
6. **The onset of the global financial crisis has aggravated economic conditions.** The sudden and sharp drop in world commodity prices resulted in a marked deterioration in the country's terms of trade—in the context of its narrow commodity export base—and a decline in foreign direct investment (FDI). This slowed economic activity, raised unemployment, and amplified macroeconomic imbalances. It also weakened fiscal performance, on top of an already low level of domestic revenue mobilization.
7. **The DRC is in debt distress.** The stock of external debt is about US\$13.1 billion with debt service amounting to one-fourth of total expenditure. At end 2008, the present value of public and publicly guaranteed external debt is estimated at 93 percent of GDP, 150 percent of exports, and 502 percent of government revenue (excluding grants), well above the policy-based threshold levels.¹ Given resource constraints, the country continues to accumulate arrears to

¹ See the joint Fund/Bank Debt Sustainability Analysis.

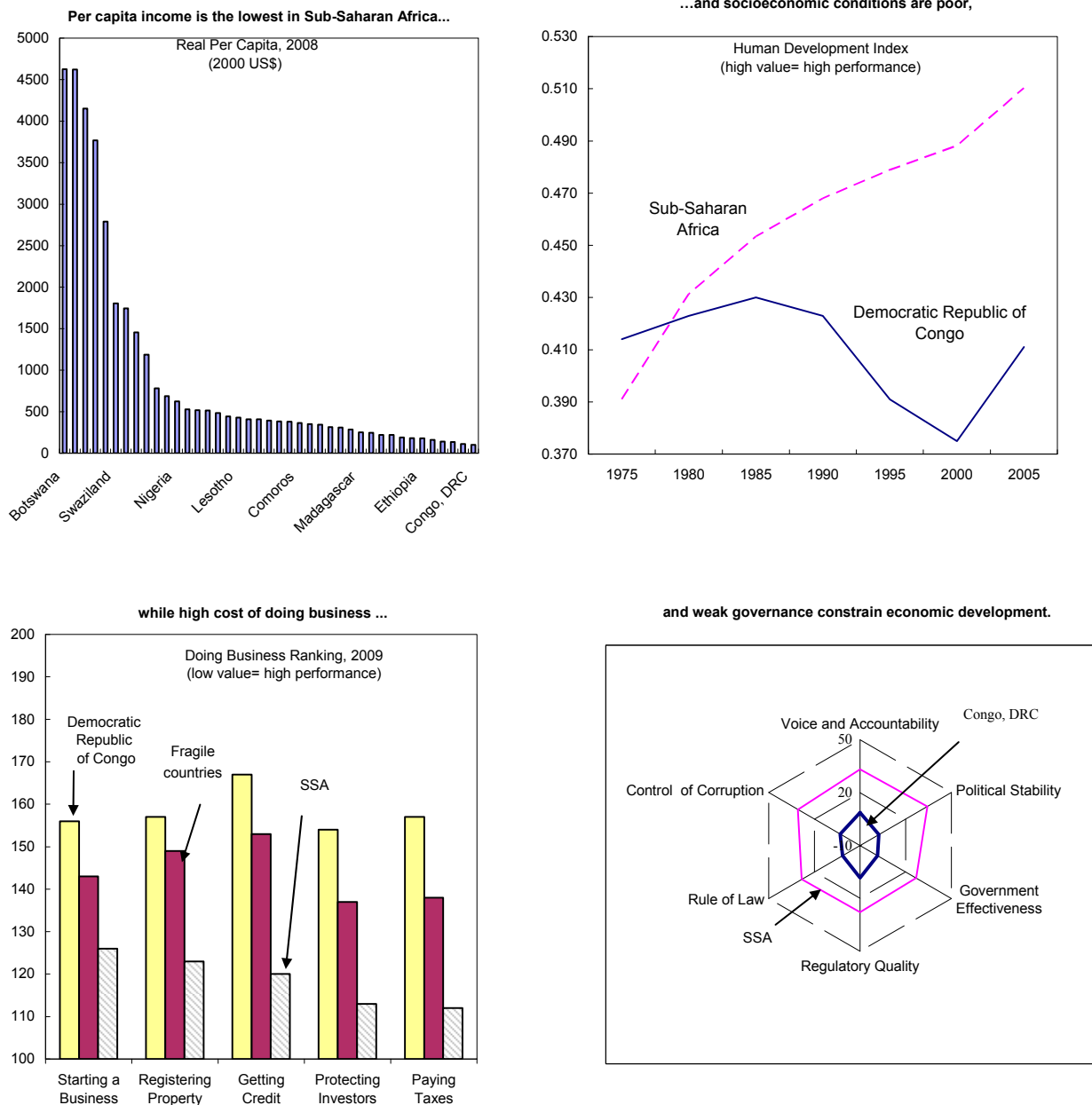
bilateral (including Paris Club) and commercial creditors, but remains current on obligations to international financial institutions. The authorities continue to seek a settlement with the London Club and other bilateral creditors on outstanding loans. The World Bank is financing, through its Debt Reduction Facility, financial and legal technical assistance to the DRC to reach a settlement with its London Club creditors.

Figure 1a. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Progress Toward Millennium Development Goals, 1990–2015
(Percent, unless otherwise indicated)



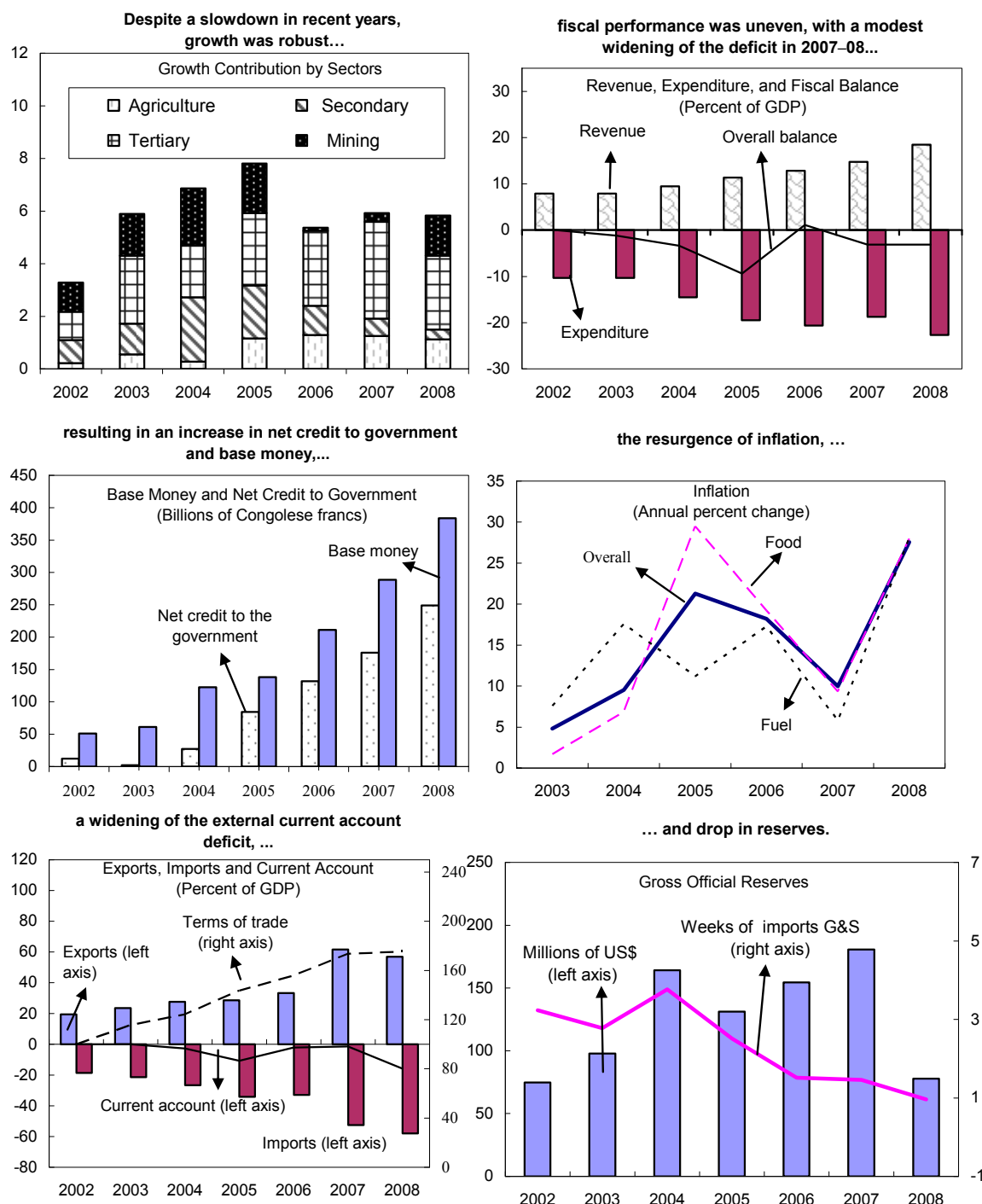
Sources: World Bank, <http://ddp-ext.worldbank.org>; and United Nations, <http://unstats.un.org>.

Figure 1b. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Social and Economic Indicators



Sources: IMF, *World Economic Outlook* (2009), World Bank, *Doing Business* (2010), and Human Development Report, 2008-09.

Figure 2. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Economic Developments, 2002–08



Sources: Congolese authorities; and IMF staff estimates.

8. **To address these challenges, the authorities are requesting a new three-year PRGF arrangement to support the implementation of their PRGS.** The program aims to bolster macroeconomic stability, strengthen PFM, reinforce central bank independence, and improve the business climate. It is underpinned by an updated PRGS (2009–10) that bridges the period the authorities need to finalize their second generation PRGS (2011–16) by June 2010.

Box 1. Democratic Republic of the Congo: The Sino-Congolese Cooperation Agreement (SCCA)

In April 2008, the DRC signed a cooperation agreement with a consortium of Chinese enterprises involving a US\$3.2 billion mining project and a set of US\$6 billion public infrastructure projects to be implemented in two phases. The Agreement was amended in October 2009 to exclude the second phase public infrastructure projects, leaving just a single phase totaling US\$3 billion to be implemented over the period 2009–14. The amended agreement also limited the government guarantee to the financing of the infrastructure projects.

The Agreement calls for the creation of a joint venture (SICOMINES) between a Congolese parastatal mining enterprise (GECAMINES) and the consortium of Chinese enterprises. Paid-in capital of US\$100 million gave GECAMINES a 32 percent equity share in the joint venture. SICOMINE will invest US\$3.2 billion in the mining project financed by a US\$1.1 billion interest-free loan and a US\$2.1 billion loan with a fixed interest rate of 6.1 percent. The US\$3 billion investment in public infrastructure is to be financed through a series of loans at a fixed interest rate of 4.4 percent. All loans are denominated in US dollars.

Operating profits from the mining project will be used to repay the mining and public infrastructure financing. The mine is expected to generate operating profits beginning in 2013. Initially, the net profits of SICOMINES will repay principal and capitalized interest on four priority public infrastructure projects (US\$375 million). After this financing is fully repaid, 85 percent of the net operating profits will be used to repay the principal and capitalized interest on the mining loan. After the mining financing has been fully repaid, 85 percent of SICOMINES' net operating profits will be used to repay the principal and capitalized interest on the remaining public infrastructure loans and the balance will be distributed as a dividend to the SICOMINES shareholders.

The grant element of the infrastructure financing is estimated at 42–46 percent, depending whether the US\$250 million signing bonus is taken into account. This is based on the following assumptions: (i) the mining project does not generate any net income and the government guarantee is invoked after 25 years as provided for under the amended Agreement; (ii) accrued interest is compounded; and (iii) a fixed interest rate of 4.4 percent applies.

II. RECENT ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENTS

9. **Macroeconomic policies were satisfactory during the first half of 2008.** The fiscal balance (cash basis) recorded modest surpluses through end-June.² Domestic revenue performance was robust and expenditures were kept in line with available resources. This allowed the central bank to contain the growth of monetary aggregates while keeping its policy rate unchanged at 28 percent.

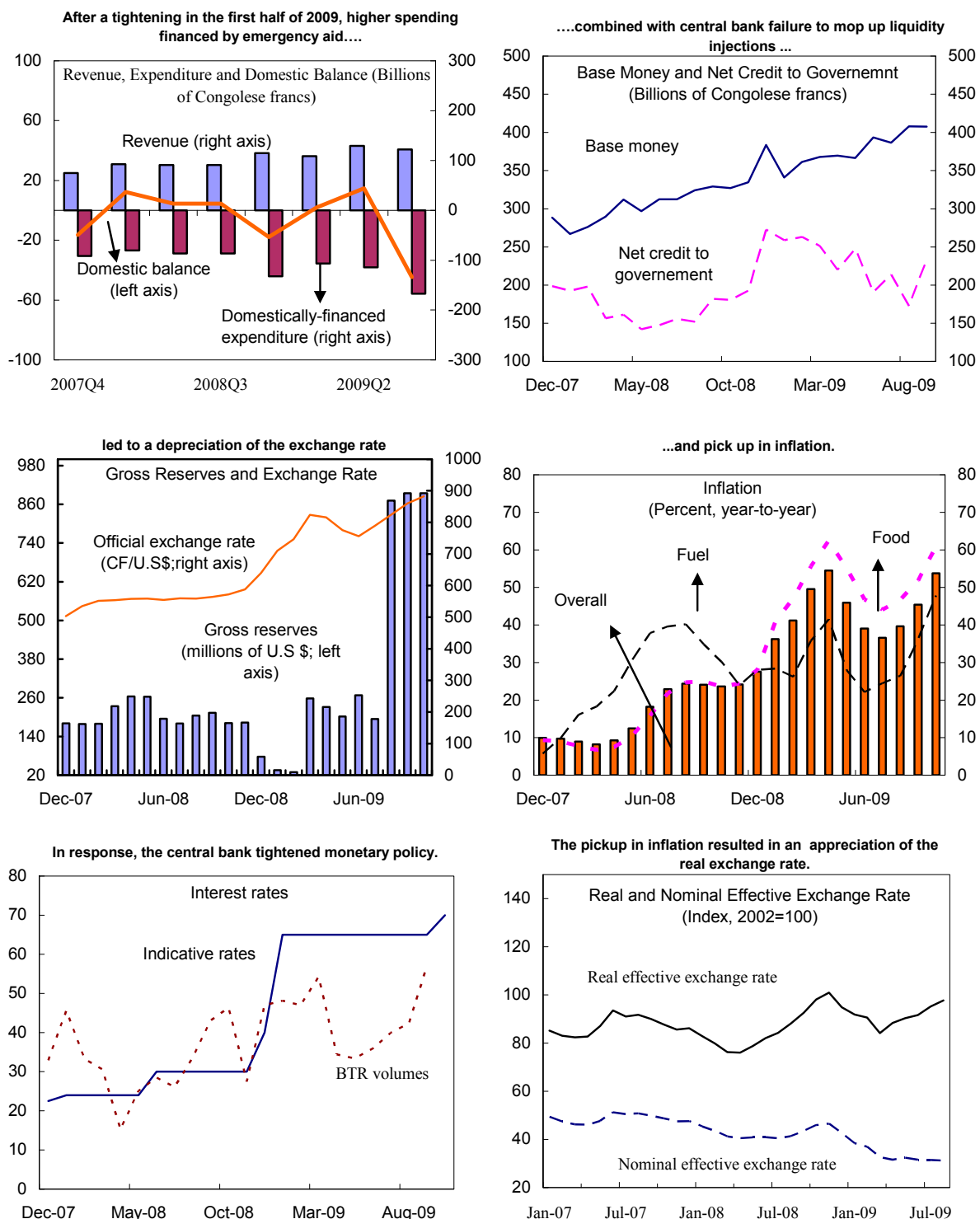
10. **The escalation of conflict weakened the fiscal position during the second half of 2008.** An acceleration of security-related spending together with weak PFM shifted the underlying fiscal balance to a deficit in the last quarter and limited the surplus for the year as a whole to about 1 percent of GDP—about 1 percentage point below target (Figure 3). Under these circumstances, net credit to government (NCG) by the Central Bank of the Congo (BCC) was 2 percentage points of GDP above target at year-end. This boosted base money and eased liquidity conditions.

11. **Macroeconomic policies were mixed through September 2009.**

- During the first half of the year, underlying fiscal surpluses (on a cash basis) averaged 0.1 percent of GDP, as the government slowed spending. During the third quarter, modest improvements in domestic revenue (excluding the SCCA signing bonus) combined with the government's success in containing expenditures kept the fiscal position in line with projections.
- On monetary policy, the BCC raised its indicative interest rate in two steps from 40 percent to 65 percent in January and stepped up sales of central bank bills. However, increased lending by the BCC to distressed banks and the failure to mop up liquidity injections by government led to periodic accelerations of base money growth during the third quarter. In response, in October the BCC raised its indicative interest rate further to 70 percent, increased the reserve requirement ratio from 5 to 7 percent, and stepped up sales of central bank bills.

² The underlying fiscal balance is defined as revenue minus expenditure excluding interest on foreign debt, foreign-financed investment, and exceptional outlays.

Figure 3. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Recent Economic Developments



Sources: Congolese authorities; and IMF staff estimates.

12. **Against this background, macroeconomic outcomes were mixed.**

- **Economic activity.** In 2008, real GDP growth was about 6 percent instead of the projected 10 percent reflecting weaker exports in the face of the global financial crisis and supply bottlenecks (especially shortages in cement and electricity) that constrained construction and manufacturing activities (Table 1). It is projected to be 2.7 percent in 2009 owing to the effects of the global financial crisis.
- **Prices.** There had been setbacks in containing inflation. After easing during the second half of 2008 thanks to the retrenchment of world fuel and food prices, inflation picked up in late 2008 and early 2009 owing mainly to government borrowing from the BCC. After a brief decline in May-August, inflation started to rise and reached 53 percent (year-on-year) at end-October in response to the periodic strong increases in base money and the depreciation of the Congolese franc. Under these circumstances, dollarization increased.
- **Current account and exchange rate.** In 2008, the external current account deficit (including transfers) widened by some 14½ percentage points of GDP to about 16 percent of GDP owing to buoyant imports and the drop of export prices in second half of the year on account of the global financial crisis. The Congolese franc depreciated by 35 percent against the U.S. dollar between December 2008 and September 2009. The real exchange rate remained broadly stable over the past several years.
- **Gross official reserves.** Reserves declined from US\$180 million at end-2007 to about US\$78 million (one week of nonaid imports) by end-2008 and further to a historically low level of US\$30 million in February 2009. They reached US\$894 million at end-September (10 weeks of nonaid import cover) following the disbursement of emergency assistance from the Fund and other development partners, the arrival of the first tranche of the SCCA signing bonus, and the general and special SDR allocations (SDR 424.5 million).

13. **Banking system soundness and vulnerability.** The health of the financial sector remains fragile (Text Table 1). At end September 2009, the capital-risk-weighted adequacy ratio averaged about 15 percent (compared with the required 10 percent), up from about 11 percent at the end of 2008. A large number of banks also have been unable to observe the required liquidity and net foreign exchange position ratios. Nonperforming loans increased significantly at the end of September 2009, reflecting in part recent improvements in the accuracy of the reporting system. The contagion effects of the global financial crisis have thus far had a limited direct impact on the banking system. Nevertheless, three local banks have shown signs of distress and urgently need to be recapitalized. The BCC is implementing a comprehensive strategy to address the issue, with technical assistance from the Fund and the World Bank. Specifically, it is strengthening on-site and off-site banking supervision and tightening and enforcing prudential regulations. It has also taken initial steps regarding the restructuring of one large bank.

Text Table 1. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Financial Soundness Indicators, 2003– September 2009							
	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	Sep-09 Prel.
Capital adequacy							
Regulatory capital to risk-weighted assets	-3.40	6.83	7.66	10.52	12.84	10.85	15.00
Regulatory Tier 1 capital to risk-weighted assets	-4.06	6.56	7.12	10.30	11.46	9.18	...
Asset Quality							
Non-performing loans to total gross loans	1.54	2.03	6.75	3.00	4.46	2.77	10.60
Non-performing loans net of provisions to capital	0.06	4.06	9.28	6.53	11.72	10.53	16.88
Earnings and profitability							
Return on assets	0.55	-1.12	1.66	2.65	2.52	2.10	0.60
Return on equity	0.59	-18.51	25.28	51.61	40.83	37.62	5.60
Interest margin to gross income	18.92	20.91	32.68	39.77	87.89	91.89	...
Non-interest expenses to gross income	77.36	86.41	58.02	44.45	79.28	79.83	...
Liquidity							
Liquid assets to total assets (liquid asset ratio)	47.03	77.19	88.46	82.99	79.80	74.77	75.00
Liquid assets to short-term liabilities	53.64	81.42	94.96	92.88	62.85	103.97	78.00
Sensitivity to market risk							
Net open in foreign exchange position to capital	29.97	52.53	12.92	50.43	41.75	-11.46	...
Foreign currency-denominated liabilities to total liabilities	69.23	80.23	73.61	76.37	76.19	81.31	91.90
Source: Central Bank of the Congo (BCC), Directory of Bank Supervision							

14. **Performance under the program to date was satisfactory.** All prior actions and indicative targets through end-September were observed and structural reforms remained on track (MEFP, Tables 1 and 2).

III. MEDIUM-TERM OUTLOOK

15. **Although short-term economic conditions remain weak, the medium-term outlook is positive.** The deterioration in the country's terms of trade and the decline in FDI on account of the global financial crisis are taking their toll on economic growth in 2009, particularly in the mining sector. Growth should pick up in 2010 and average 6.5 percent in 2010–12, supported by higher public and private investment and a recovery in the mining sector. However, it will remain below the 8 percent projected during the previous Article IV consultation (SM/07/293). Inflation should decline to 48.7 percent by end-2009 and to single digits by 2012, supported by prudent fiscal and monetary policies. Given an expected gradual recovery in exports and large increases in investment-related imports, the current account deficit is expected to widen over the medium term, but will be financed in large part by capital and financial flows tied to infrastructure and mining projects. Gross reserves will remain to the equivalent of about 10 weeks of imports in 2012, in large part supported by the government's decision to save the SDR allocations and maintain them in SDRs.

IV. ARTICLE IV CONSULTATION AND POLICY DISCUSSIONS

16. **Drawing on the recommendations from the 2007 Article IV consultation (Box 2), the 2009 Article IV consultation discussions centered on three main themes:** (i) fostering sustained and high economic growth; (ii) enhancing external sustainability; and (iii) strengthening institutional capacity for economic management.

Box 2: Democratic Republic of the Congo: Main Recommendations of the 2007 Article IV Consultations	
Improve revenue collection, including through a comprehensive reform of collection agencies.	While progress was made in improving revenue collection, there have been delays in reforming the collection agencies, increasing mining sector taxation, and simplifying taxes.
Improve PFM and prioritization of spending.	There was progress in addressing the urgent spending procedures, but comprehensive PFM reform remains at infancy stage and the lingering conflict undermines spending prioritization.
Reform the financial sector.	Some progress has been made in strengthening banking supervision and reinforcing compliance with prudential regulations, but efforts to restructure weak banks has been slow.
Address fiscal dominance and enhance central bank independence.	Reducing fiscal dominance has been hampered by periods of increased government borrowing from the central bank partly related to the lingering conflict in the eastern provinces; restructuring of the central bank is proceeding.
Implement structural reforms to enhance the economy's supply response.	Initial steps were taken to prepare key public enterprises for privatization, but reforms to streamline the regulatory environment and address governance problems have been slow.

A. Fostering Sustained and High Economic Growth

17. **Sustained and high economic growth is critical to increasing per capita income and reducing poverty.** The authorities agreed with staff that this requires bolstering macroeconomic stability, creating fiscal space for the provision of critical public goods, and advancing structural reforms to foster private sector development.

18. **Moving toward macroeconomic stability.** Given the country's history of hyperinflation and uneven implementation of policies, staff believe that the fiscal policy rule of zero net bank credit to the government is critical to taming inflation and addressing fiscal dominance over monetary policy. The central bank would need to remain vigilant and mop up any excess liquidity, particularly those related to donor-financed public spending. The authorities agreed on the need to avoid recourse to central bank borrowing as this would reduce the burden on monetary policy in an environment where its effectiveness is already limited by the high degree of dollarization and underdeveloped financial markets. The authorities and staff also concurred that the reorganizing, restructuring, and recapitalizing the central bank is critical to enhancing its independence and capacity to conduct monetary and exchange rate policy.

19. **Increasing fiscal space for priority spending.** To create such space, the authorities need to mobilize domestic revenues and strengthen PFM. Staff noted the low levels of tax collection to date, particularly in the mineral sector, and the importance of increasing domestic revenues to address the country's large reconstruction needs. The authorities agreed that bold reforms are needed to modernize and consolidate tax and customs management, streamline exemptions, and simplify the tax system, including introducing a VAT. They maintained, however, that this would need to be addressed over the medium term given capacity constraints. However, they have already begun taking steps to strengthen mining sector tax collection, including by reviewing exemptions and establishing a unit within the tax administration dedicated to this sector.

20. **PFM.** Poor budget planning, circumvention of budgetary procedures, and ineffective budget controls have weakened fiscal discipline and accountability. This, together with high levels of nondiscretionary spending, impedes progress in achieving the country's poverty reduction objectives. Staff stressed the importance of realistic budgets, following proper budgetary procedures, strengthening controls, and improving priority expenditure tracking. Strengthening institutional capacity in PFM at the provincial level, with technical assistance from development partners, will also be important given the ongoing decentralization. The authorities concurred with the staff's assessment and noted that progress on these fronts would also help allay concerns over governance. They stressed that the speed of PFM reforms should take into account the country's post-conflict situation.

21. **Improving the business climate.** Staff urged the authorities to press ahead with reforms to reduce the cost of doing business and to diversify the economy. The authorities indicated that they are placing emphasis on restructuring public enterprises and privatizing the management of key public services (i.e., transport and utilities) as a first step toward privatization. They plan to submit to parliament a law that will allow the DRC to participate in the Organization for the Harmonization of Business Law in Africa (OHADA), which will help simplify procedures for business registration and strengthen legal protection of foreign investment. The authorities also noted that they established and staffed the office responsible for the implementation of the 2004 anti-money laundering and combating financing of terrorism legislation. Staff welcomed these efforts, but encouraged the authorities to advance reforms in the areas of banking supervision, credit information management, and the judiciary.

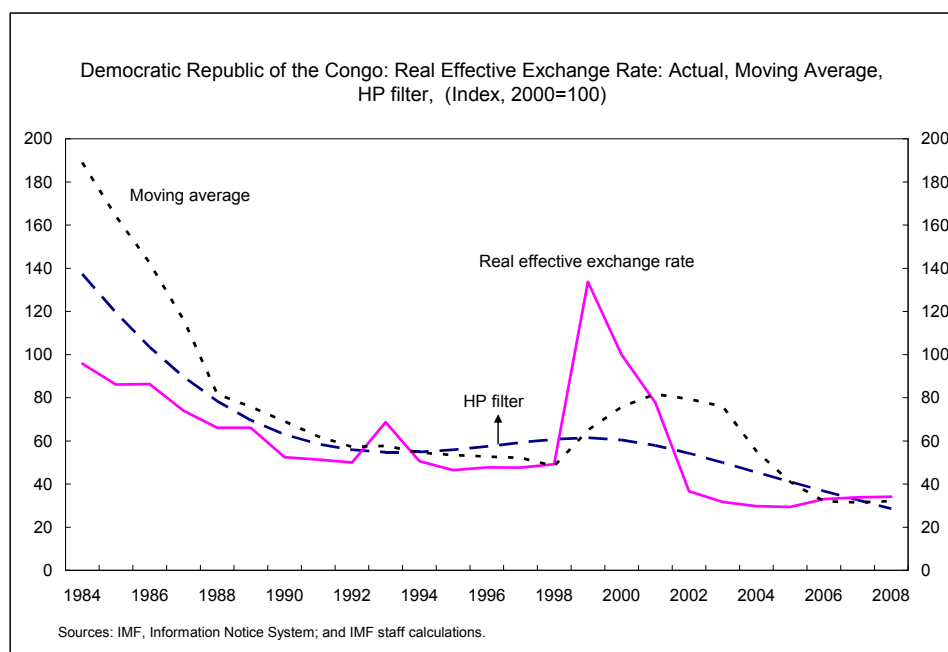
B. Enhancing External Sustainability

22. **A flexible exchange rate regime is appropriate given the country's low level of foreign reserves and vulnerability to exogenous shocks** (Box 3). Staff noted that the exchange rate has broadly tracked economic fundamentals and appears appropriate assuming that donor flows continue and the DRC benefits from debt relief under the enhanced HIPC Initiative and Multilateral Debt Relief Initiative (MDRI). The authorities concurred, noting that the central bank intervenes in the foreign exchange market to achieve its reserve target and to smooth sharp fluctuations in the rate. Staff stressed that this could best be addressed by advancing reforms to reduce the cost of doing business.

Box 3. Democratic Republic of the Congo: An Assessment of the Exchange Rate Policy and External Competitiveness

The exchange rate of the Congo franc has been freely floating since the liberalization of the foreign exchange market and the unification of the exchange rate in 2001. Since then, BCC intervention in the foreign exchange market has been limited. Thus, the exchange rate appears to have been responsive to changes in macroeconomic policies and exogenous shocks. The nominal effective exchange rate of the Congo franc (NEER) depreciated by 10 percent a year on average over 2002–08 while the real effective exchange rate (REER) appreciated by 2 percent on average over the same period. Although assessing the equilibrium exchange rate is a complicated exercise, particularly in a post-conflict country with poor data and significant structural breaks, two approaches were used to assess the consistency of the real exchange rate with its equilibrium level.

1. An estimation of the long-run trend of the real exchange rate by using standard smoothing filters—Five-year moving average of the REER and the Hodrik Prescott (HP) filter—to isolate the permanent component from the transient and short term shocks. The smoothed variable is then interpreted as the equilibrium real exchange rate. In 2002–08, the actual REER was below its equilibrium level most of the period, but appears to have converged to its equilibrium level at the end of the period.



2. An application of the macro-balance approach developed by the Consultative Group on Exchange Rate Issues. It consists of three steps. First, estimating an underlying current account (UCA) based on the medium term framework, excluding temporary factors. Second, computing a current account norm (CAN) based on the fundamentals. Third, deriving the adjustment in the REER necessary to close the gap between UCA and CAN, assuming import and export elasticities. Using different approaches, the UCA is estimated at a deficit of around 12 percent of GDP. The CAN is derived from variables and estimated coefficients on a panel of developing countries (see Isard and others (*IMF Occasional Paper*, 2001)). Essentially driven by low level of net foreign assets and foreign aid, the CAN is estimated at about -8.4 percent. Using standard export and import elasticities, the analysis suggests the exchange rate would need to depreciate by about 9 percent to close the gap between the UCA and the CAN.

The above results do not suggest significant over or under valuation of the exchange rate. However, the inability by the DRC to fully service its debt (and thus accumulate arrears on its external debt) suggests that macroeconomic policies and structural reforms were insufficient to generate the growth and resources needed to fully meet debt service obligations. Nevertheless, the exchange rate level would be appropriate if foreign aid flows continue and the DRC benefits from debt relief from the enhanced HIPC initiative and the MDRI.

23. **The DRC's debt situation is unsustainable absent substantial debt relief.** Debt burden indicators markedly exceed their policy-based thresholds.³ In the absence of debt relief from the enhanced HIPC Initiative and the MDRI, external debt burden indicators are projected to remain above policy-dependent thresholds over prolonged periods. The DRC will continue to be vulnerable to adverse exogenous shocks even after access to debt relief under the enhanced HIPC Initiative and MDRI reduces the country's debt burden indicators below the thresholds. It is expected to reach the HIPC Completion point at earliest during the second quarter of 2010, assuming completion of the first review of the PRGF arrangement, indications that program implementation through end-March 2010 remains satisfactory, one-year satisfactory implementation of their PRGS, and observance of the HIPC triggers (Table 7). The authorities committed to adhere to a debt strategy that minimizes the risks of debt stress by relying strictly on grants or highly concessional loans. In this context, they have agreed with their partners to remove from the SCCA the second phase infrastructure projects and the government guarantee on the mining project.

C. Strengthening Institutional Capacity for Economic Management

24. **Fragmented institutions and political considerations have complicated policy management.** The bifurcation of the ministries in charge of finance and budget impedes efficiency and coordination of fiscal policy. This, along with weak monetary policy coordination and fragmentation of responsibilities across other ministries, complicates policy implementation and reform. These weaknesses would likely be exacerbated by the constitutionally mandated fiscal decentralization policy given weak PFM at the provincial level. Staff encouraged the authorities to merge the ministries in charge of finance and budget, improve fiscal and monetary policy coordination, and strengthen the institutional capacities of provinces. The authorities agreed, but stressed that this should be seen in the context of the country's nascent institutions and broad-based government coalition that has played a critical role in national reconciliation.

25. **Improvement in economic statistics is critical for program implementation and monitoring.** Weaknesses in data preparation, timeliness, and quality persist on account of inadequate human and material resources and weak coordination. Staff urged the authorities to adopt a new statistics law, finalize their national strategy for statistics development, and complete the new national accounts. The authorities indicated that they would do so, but stressed that rebuilding capacity in post-conflict setting would require substantial donor assistance.

V. THE PROGRAM FOR 2009–12

26. **The authorities are requesting a three-year PRGF arrangement and disbursement of additional interim assistance under the enhanced HIPC Initiative** to support their economic program over the period July 2009 to June 2012. The program's objectives are: (i) average real GDP growth of 5.5 percent; (ii) end-period inflation rate of 9 percent by 2012;

³ See the joint Bank/Fund Debt Sustainability Analysis.

(iii) gross reserves equivalent to 10 weeks of nonaid imports by 2012; and (iv) the external current account deficit (including grants) limited to an average of 25 percent of GDP. The program supports the implementation of the authorities' PRGS (Box 4) and underpinning policies and reforms, which are presented in the attached Letter of Intent (LOI), Memorandum of Economic and Financial Policies (MEFP), and Technical Memorandum of Understanding (TMU). The program focuses on enhancing macroeconomic stability, mobilizing domestic revenues, strengthening PFM, reforming the central bank, and improving the business climate.

Box 4. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Poverty Reduction and Growth Strategy (PRGS)

The authorities completed their first full PRGS paper covering the period 2006–08 through a participatory process in July 2006. It was endorsed by the democratically elected government in March 2007. The strategy is based on five pillars:

- Promotion of peace and good governance;
- Consolidation of macroeconomic stability and promotion of economic growth;
- Improvement in access to social services;
- Fight against HIV/AIDS; and
- Promotion of a dynamic community

In their PRSP Progress Report dated July 2008, the authorities acknowledged that the strategy was overly ambitious and its implementation hindered by the conflict in the eastern provinces, capacity constraints, and budgetary constraints. As a result, there was little progress in achieving the PRGS objectives and key social indicators did not improve significantly, with the exception of primary education enrollment and maternal mortality rates. Delays in rebuilding the democratic institutions also affected the government's ability monitor key reforms.

With a view to ensuring the achievement of the PRGS objectives despite the problems experienced to date, the authorities decided to extend their strategy for an additional 18 months through the end of 2010. They have adopted an updated Priority Action Plan (PAP2) for the period 2009–10 that seeks to correct the weaknesses identified in the progress report by prioritizing the key policies and actions to be implemented. Aligning the budget with these priorities will be a key element of the government's strategy going forward. Given that the poverty dynamics in the DRC remain unchanged, staff believes that the current PRGS remains as the appropriate basis for underpinning the PRGF in 2009 and 2010.

In parallel, the authorities are preparing their second generation PRGS, which will cover the period 2011–15. This document will be developed in a participatory manner, including at the provincial level, and is expected to be completed and approved by December 2010.

A. Macroeconomic Policies

27. Macroeconomic policies aim at reducing inflation and supporting strong and sustained economic growth. Fiscal policy will avoid recourse to central bank financing and lay the foundation for long-term sustainability. Absent fiscal dominance, monetary policy will focus on reducing inflation to single digits in the context of a flexible exchange rate regime.

Fiscal policy

28. The budget deficits will be capped by the availability of concessional foreign assistance. In this context, the underlying fiscal balance (cash basis) is targeted to shift from a deficit of 2.1 percent of GDP in 2009 to 0.4 percent in 2012 (Table 2). This fiscal adjustment is consistent with the government's objectives of zero net borrowing from the banking sector and,

thus, reducing fiscal dominance over monetary policy.⁴ Under the assumption that the DRC receives substantial debt relief under the enhanced HIPC Initiative and MDRI, the program's medium-term fiscal adjustment is consistent with fiscal sustainability over the long term.⁵ Domestic revenue (excluding the signing bonus from the SCCA) is projected to increase from 15.7 percent of GDP to about 20 percent over the same period. The projections are reasonable given DRC's post-conflict situation whereby economic recovery, expansion of central government's authority over the eastern provinces, the teething of tax and customs administration reforms, and the introduction of a VAT are expected to improve revenue collection.⁶ This, along with scaled up development assistance, should allow higher domestic spending on priority programs. The government is committed to reduce nonpriority spending (including investment and transfers) in the event that domestic revenue or external budget support are lower than envisaged. Further, the fiscal program provides for a budget reserve for unanticipated events, such as natural disasters and security-related spending. The staff will continue to work closely with the authorities to improve reporting on budget execution, including information on social and other priority spending.

29. The resolution of the conflict in the eastern provinces and the improved relationship between the DRC and its neighbors will reduce security-related spending. In recent years, security-related spending constrained other priority spending and complicated budget planning. Over the medium term, improved security conditions will help enhance expenditure allocation, reduce recourse to urgent spending procedures, and make budget planning more predictable. This should facilitate the implementation of the second generation PRGS.

Monetary and exchange rate policies

30. The objective of monetary policy is to achieve single-digit inflation by 2012. Progress on this front is critical to fostering confidence in the local currency. Base money will remain as the nominal anchor. Pending the development of a treasury bill market, the BCC will primarily use central bank bills to mop up excess liquidity (MEFP ¶21). As necessary, it will auction foreign exchange to sterilize liquidity arising from donor-financed government spending. The BCC will improve its liquidity forecasting in close collaboration with the Treasury.

31. The BCC will rebuild its gross official foreign reserves. The program objective is to maintain gross official reserves at the equivalent of 10 weeks of import coverage by 2012. This level corresponds to slightly below one standard deviation of export levels and should therefore be adequate, particularly given the country's free-floating exchange rate regime. The BCC will intervene in the foreign exchange market only to smooth large fluctuations in the rate and to achieve the foreign reserve target (MEFP ¶21).⁷ To support reserve build up while fostering financial market development, the authorities are ceasing making payments in foreign exchange to domestic suppliers and requiring tax payments to be made in local currency.

⁴ The zero net credit to government target for the year as whole is consistent with net borrowing within the year for treasury management purposes. The ceiling will limit undue exposure to domestic debt and the crowding out of private sector credit.

⁵ The program also includes a zero ceiling on nonconcessional external borrowing.

⁶ In 2002–08, the revenue-GDP ratio increased on average by some 2 percentage points notwithstanding the effects of the lingering conflict in the eastern provinces and slow implementation of reforms.

⁷ The central bank may also intervene to avoid market disruptions due to the small size of the market.

B. Structural Reforms

32. **The authorities' structural reform agenda will focus on domestic revenue mobilization, PFM, central bank reform, and private sector development.** The proposed reforms are drawn from those outlined in the PRGS. Given the complementarity of reforms in achieving the authorities' objectives, the PRGF-supported program will be coordinated closely with other development partners (Text Table 2).

33. **Domestic revenue mobilization.** The focus is on expanding the tax base by streamlining tax exemptions in the investment, mining, and forestry codes with a view to eliminating them over time. Strengthening the Large Taxpayers Unit at the income tax department will improve tax collection from mining companies (MEFP ¶26), while the introduction of a VAT in 2012 will allow for the removal of various discretionary taxes (MEFP ¶23). To prepare for this, the authorities plan to establish tax collection centers for medium-sized enterprises across the country. Customs administration reform aims at reducing fraud, shortening clearance delays, and improving valuation (MEFP ¶24). The customs administration will be transformed into a department of the Ministry of Finance with its own budget. Key priorities will include improving the monitoring of mining exports, expanding one-stop customs windows at border posts, modernizing information management, enforcing pre-inspection regulations and enhancing antifraud activities, and implementing a single taxpayer identification number.

34. **PFM.** The focus is on strengthening budget preparation, execution, and accountability (MEFP ¶27). The authorities will adopt an organic public finance law aimed at rationalizing and harmonizing the budget process. Budget planning and control will be strengthened by developing a medium-term expenditure framework in cooperation with line ministries and by requiring all government transactions to adhere to proper budget procedures. Other key reforms include the introduction of a double entry accounting system at the treasury, enhancement of ex ante and ex post budget controls, and preparation and implementation of an action plan to strengthen PFM at the provincial level.

35. **Central Bank reform.** The focus is on restoring the BCC's independence (MEFP ¶30) and strengthening its supervisory capacity (MEFP ¶31) with the technical assistance from the IMF's Monetary and Capital Markets (MCM) department. Given the BCC's limited income base—low seignorage (due to dollarization), and interest earnings on foreign reserves (due to low level of interest-bearing reserves), restructuring and reorganization are critical to make the bank more efficient. This in turn will facilitate its recapitalization by the government. Strengthening banking supervision will involve improving the legal and regulatory framework, and reinforcing banking supervision capacity, including human and material resource requirements.

36. **Private sector development.** Key elements include reforming public enterprises (MEFP ¶37), streamlining government regulations and protecting foreign investment (MEFP ¶33), and improving transparency in natural resource management by adhering to the EITI (MEFP ¶36).

Text Table 2: Democratic Republic of the Congo: Structural Reform and Burden Sharing

	IMF	Other Agencies
Fiscal Structural Reforms		
Tax and customs administration	IMF	World Bank
Public financial management	IMF	World Bank
Decentralization	IMF	World Bank
Debt management	IMF	World Bank/UNCTAD
Monetary and Financial Sector Reforms		
Central Bank reform	IMF	
Monetary operations	IMF	Belgium
Foreign exchange market reforms	IMF	
Payment system		World Bank/USAID
Banking supervision	IMF	
Restructuring of financial institutions		World Bank
Microfinance		World Bank
Other Reforms		
Civil service		World Bank
Public enterprises		World Bank
Regulatory environment for business		World Bank
Judicial		World Bank/EC
Extractive industries		World Bank
Governance	IMF	World Bank/EC
Trade	IMF	World Bank

VI. THE 2009 AND 2010 PROGRAM

37. **The program objectives for 2009** are: (i) real GDP growth of 2.7 percent; (ii) an end-of-period inflation rate of 48.7 percent; and (iii) gross official reserves equivalent to 10 weeks of nonaid imports.

Macroeconomic policies

38. **The fiscal program targets a reduction in government borrowing from the banking sector.** The underlying fiscal deficit (cash basis) is therefore targeted at 2.1 percent of GDP, a deterioration of about 3 percentage points of GDP relative to 2008. This will allow a reduction in net credit to government of about 1.2 percent of GDP, reflecting the savings of a large portion of the signing bonus of the SCCA. To reach the deficit target, domestic revenues (excluding the signing bonus) are projected at 15.7 percent of GDP (about 3 percentage points less than in 2008), reflecting mainly the impact of lower petroleum prices and weak economic activity. Further, domestically financed spending (outside exceptional outlays) is targeted at 16.3 percent of GDP.

39. **The fiscal objectives for the remainder of 2009 appear to be achievable.** Domestic revenue is expected to be line with program objectives for the year as a whole. On the expenditure side, the authorities have taken corrective measures to address a large build up of expenditure commitments in October that could have threatened the fiscal targets. Specifically, they cancelled all commitments for which goods and services have not yet been delivered

(CF 68 billion) and delayed the repayment of arrears from 2007 and 2008 pending the outcome of an ongoing audit (CF 31 billion). They also ceased all new expenditure commitments as of end-October in line with budget procedures and reallocated credits for discretionary spending to offset higher priority spending (i.e., goods and services and domestically financed investment). These measures should keep the underlying fiscal deficit in line with the program objective.

40. **In 2010, fiscal policy will further enhance macroeconomic stability.** Staff reached understandings on a 2010 fiscal framework, which is consistent with draft budget submitted by government to parliament. The underlying fiscal deficit (cash basis) is projected to decline to 0.5 percent of GDP in 2010. Higher domestically financed expenditure outside exceptional spending (18 percent of GDP or about 2 percentage points more than in 2009) will be accommodated by an increase in domestic revenues. Foreign-financed capital expenditure, which includes the infrastructures projects implemented under the SCCA, is projected to reach 14 percent of GDP. The resulting overall fiscal deficit on a cash basis (12.7 percent of GDP) will be entirely financed through external budget and project support, with no recourse to domestic financing. In this regard, the authorities have committed to reduce spending—mainly in the areas of goods and services and domestically financed investment in non-priority programs—in the event that domestic revenue or external budget support is lower than programmed.

41. **Monetary policy for the remainder of 2009 and in 2010 aims to reduce further end-year inflation to 48.7 percent and 15 percent, respectively.** The BCC intends to maintain a tight monetary policy stance to achieve its inflations objectives. In this context, base money growth is targeted at 19.6 percent and 22 percent in 2009 and 2010, respectively, in line with nominal GDP growth and the inflation objectives (Table 3). In addition to the use of central bank bills to achieve the monetary targets, the BCC may auction foreign exchange while achieving its gross reserves target. The central bank will maintain its current policy rate to support disinflation.

42. **The program is fully financed.** After taking into account debt relief under the enhanced HIPC Initiative and MDRI, the remaining balance of payments financing gap for July 2009-June 2010 is estimated at about US\$154 million. This is expected to be covered by the first and second disbursements under the PRGF. The financing gap for the period July-December 2010 is estimated at US\$355 and is expected to be covered by budget support from the World Bank (US\$100 million), the European Commission (US\$66 million), and bilateral development partners (US\$189 million). In the event of a shortfall in external budget support, the disbursement of the second tranche of the SCCA signing bonus (US\$125 million), which is expected in December 2009, could be used.

Structural reforms

43. **Structural reforms in 2009 and 2010 will focus on the areas of tax and customs administration, PFM, and the financial sector (MEFP ¶42).**

44. **Fiscal structural reforms aim at strengthening tax administration and PFM.** The focus is to establish new tax centers for medium-sized enterprises in key provinces while strengthening the existing ones. Customs administration will also be improved by computerizing border posts and increasing the diffusion of one-stop windows. The simplification and rationalization of revenue collection will be accompanied by the assessment and elimination of nuisance taxes. On PFM, key reforms include bolstering budget planning and execution by, *inter alia*, adopting an organic budget law, eliminating extra budgetary spending, enhancing the PFM capacities of local governments, and improving the reliability of fiscal reporting.

45. **Financial sector reforms would focus on strengthening the role and independence of the central bank.** The BCC will first implement a new reorganization and restructuring plan that will help put the bank's financial situation on sustainable financial footing. The government will in turn adopt a recapitalization plan for the BCC to restore its independence. With regard to banking supervision, the focus will be on completing financial audits of the commercial banks and developing restructuring plans for those that are financially weak. The BCC is tightening prudential ratios and their monitoring, in line with recommendation by IMF technical assistance. Further, the authorities have initiated the implementation of the 2004 anti-money laundering and combating financing terrorism legislation.

VII. ACCESS AND PROGRAM MONITORING

46. **Access under the proposed program is consistent with the country's balance of payments needs.** The proposed access of 65 percent of quota (SDR 346.45 million) takes into account the strength of the program, projected donor contributions, and the high level of external debt. The level of access is relatively modest in light of the severe debt situation and the substantial risks to the program. Fund financial support would represent 38 percent of the balance of payments need over 2010–12 (Tables 4 and 5). Disbursements will be conditioned on the completion of semiannual reviews. Access levels can be revisited and augmented if need be after the Completion point and/or in the event of a subsequent exogenous shock. The authorities are also requesting additional interim assistance under the enhanced HIPC initiative in the amount of SDR 45.66 million (20 percent of the total HIPC commitment) to help cover 51.1 percent of the principal repayments falling due to the IMF during the twelve-month period from December 2009.⁸

47. **The program will be monitored based on a set of quantitative semiannual performance criteria and quarterly indicators, while structural reforms will be assessed in the context of semiannual reviews.** The proposed program would begin on July 1, 2009. The quantitative performance criteria and indicators include ceilings on: (i) net credit to government by the banking sector; (ii) net domestic assets of the central bank; (iii) net foreign assets of the central bank; (iv) central bank payments on government expenditure without prior authorization

⁸ The Fund committed SDR 228.3 million in HIPC assistance at the decision point, of which SDR 3.394 million was disbursed as interim assistance in three tranches during 2003–05, before DRC's last PRGF-supported program went off-track.

by the ministers of finance and budget; (v) external arrears; and (vi) nonconcessional external debt (MEFP, Table 1). The first review is to be completed by end-June 2010 and would cover macroeconomic developments and policies for 2010 and progress in structural reforms in tax and customs administration, PFM, and the financial sector. The second review is to be completed by end-December 2010 and would cover macroeconomic developments and policies for 2011 and debt sustainability after debt relief.

48. **In the context of the proposed PRGF, an update safeguards assessment of the BCC is currently in progress.** The previous update assessment, concluded in January 2008, found a strengthened external audit mechanism, but significant safeguards risks remained in the control framework of the central bank, including serious concerns regarding the bank's independence. As a result, the assessment recommended specific measures for implementation in advance of a Board discussion of a new PRGF arrangement. The BCC agreed with the findings of the assessment and committed to implementing the safeguards recommendations, some of which were prior actions and others are structural benchmarks in the proposed PRGF program. Staff is monitoring BCC's implementation of the measures. The update assessment will be completed by no later than the first review.

49. **The authorities have strengthened their program monitoring capacity at both the political and technical level with a view to ensuring coordination across ministries.** They have created a Poverty Reduction Strategy National Steering Commission (PRS-NSC) under the authority of the Prime Minister which is responsible for supervising two commissions involved in the design and implementation of the poverty reduction and growth strategy (MEFP ¶46). An interministerial technical committee will serve as the main counterpart to Fund staff regarding program monitoring, reporting, and implementation.

VIII. CAPACITY TO REPAY THE FUND AND RISKS

50. **The DRC's capacity to repay the Fund is satisfactory, assuming debt relief** (Table 6). There are significant risks that, absent higher external balance of payments support and debt relief under the enhanced HIPC Initiative and MDRI, the DRC would be in a difficult position to meet its obligations to the Fund. Assuming such external financing and debt relief, repayment obligations to the Fund would peak at about 3.4 percent of exports in 2009–10 and average about 1 percent of exports in 2010–22. Purchases under the proposed PRGF program would not have a significant impact on the external debt outlook. They would raise the present value of external public and publicly-guaranteed debt by a maximum of 2.9 percentage points in 2012 and decline below 0.7 of a percentage point by 2019.

51. **The implementation of the program is subject to downside risks.** An escalation in the conflict in the eastern provinces and/or exogenous adverse shocks such as a drop in the terms of trade could dampen economic growth, reduce revenues, worsen macroeconomic imbalances, and increase inflation and exchange rate volatility. Delayed financial sector reforms could further weaken the health of the financial sector and destabilize the economy. Weak PFM and government acquiescence to expenditure pressures (especially on public sector wages) could undermine the fiscal program and place pressures on inflation and the exchange rate. Lack of strong political will to carry forward proposed reforms could also derail the program.

IX. STAFF APPRAISAL

52. **The DRC faces critical development challenges.** Although there has been good progress in macroeconomic stabilization, challenges remain to establish sustainable growth and fiscal space for poverty reduction. In this context, staff welcome the authorities' ambitious reform agenda, but implementation will require strong leadership to build a broad consensus in support of the program.

53. **Macroeconomic stabilization requires a prudent and credible fiscal policy.** Expenditure discipline will be critical to achieving the program's fiscal objectives. The recent actions by the government to reduce expenditure commitments and delay the repayment of arrears pending their audit are encouraging. However, durable fiscal discipline will, *inter alia*, require the alignment of the treasury and expenditure commitment plans in order to avoid an excessive build up of commitments as in 2009. Progress on this front will help avoid a build up in domestic arrears and reduce central bank financing of the deficit. In this context, the authorities' decision to bolster the coordination of fiscal policy implementation, including through the active participation of the council of ministers, is welcome.

54. **Priority spending needs to be safeguarded.** Improvements in domestic revenue in the context of the expected economic recovery should help increase priority spending in line with the PRGS. A prudent wage policy is also critical for achieving the established macroeconomic objectives while avoiding the crowding out of priority spending programs.

55. **Strengthening PFM is paramount to enhancing the efficiency and credibility of the budget process.** This involves strengthening revenue collection, rationalizing spending procedures, minimizing recourse to urgent spending procedures, and improving priority expenditure tracking. Civil service reform and strengthened payroll management will also be essential to containing the wage bill.

56. **A tight monetary policy stance is critical for reducing inflation.** In this regard, the recent tightening of monetary policy by the BCC in response to a pick in inflation is welcome. This policy needs to be maintained in order to achieve inflation objective. To improve the effectiveness of monetary policy, the BCC should implement MCM TA recommendations regarding improving liquidity forecast in close collaboration with the Treasury, deepening monetary policy instruments and foreign reserve management. It should also improve the transparency of its operations in order to increase the credibility of its monetary policy. Foreign exchange market interventions should be limited to smoothing daily fluctuations and bridging private sector demand with forex generated from donor flows.

57. **Structural reforms to help enhance the economy's supply response should be a high priority.** The focus should be on addressing delays in mining sector and public enterprise reforms, accelerating adherence to the EITI, and reforming the judiciary. The recent establishment of the office responsible for the implementation of the 2004 anti-money laundering and combating financing terrorism is welcome.

58. **Debt sustainability hinges on debt relief.** In the absence of debt relief under the HIPC Initiative and MDRI, external debt burden indicators are projected to remain above policy-dependent thresholds over prolonged periods. It is therefore crucial that the government implements all measures (including the HIPC triggers) required to reach the completion point under the enhanced HIPC Initiative as soon as possible. Strengthening debt management, including the avoidance of nonconcessional public debt, will also be important. The amendment to the SCCA that made it consistent with debt sustainability is welcome.

59. **The staff is of the view that the Lending into Arrears Policy should be applied.** This is based on the financing assurances review conducted by staff, the good faith efforts exerted by the authorities toward reaching collaborative agreements with commercial creditors, and the fact that relations with commercial creditors would not undermine the program.

60. **There are downside risks to the program.** An escalation in the conflict in the eastern provinces and adverse exogenous shocks could dampen economic growth, weaken domestic revenue, and worsen macroeconomic imbalances. Weak PFM and institutional capacity could also undermine the program. These risks can be lowered by the ongoing internationally supported peace efforts and increased donor financial and technical assistance.

61. **The authorities' program promotes sustained high levels of growth and poverty reduction.** Staff supports the authorities' request for a three-year PRGF arrangement and additional interim assistance under the enhanced HIPC Initiative. This will help close the remaining balance of payments financing gap and catalyze donor assistance to support the DRC in implementing its development agenda. Staff believe that satisfactory assurances regarding interim HIPC debt relief are in place from the African Development Fund and the International Development Agency.

62. **It is proposed that the next Article IV consultation cycle with the DRC be held in** accordance with the provisions on the decision on consultation cycles approved on July 15, 2002.

PROPOSED DECISIONS

The following decisions are proposed for adoption by the Executive Board:

Decision A. Democratic Republic of the Congo - Poverty Reduction and Growth

Facility – Three-Year Arrangement

1. The Democratic Republic of the Congo has requested a three-year arrangement under the Poverty Reduction and Growth Facility in a total amount equivalent to SDR 346.45 million.

2. The Fund approves the arrangement set forth in EBS/09/191, (12/1/09), and decides that the Democratic Republic of the Congo may request the first disbursement under the arrangement, on the condition that the information provided by the Democratic Republic of the Congo on the implementation of the measures specified as prior actions in Table I.2 of the Memorandum of Economic and Financial Policies attached to the Letter from the Prime Minister of the Democratic Republic of the Congo dated November 30, 2009, is accurate.

Decision B. Democratic Republic of the Congo – Enhanced Initiative for Heavily Indebted Poor Countries – Additional Interim Assistance

The Fund as Trustee (the “Trustee”) of the Trust for Special PRGF Operations for the Heavily Indebted Poor Countries and Interim PRGF Subsidy Operations (the “Trust”), established by Decision No. 11436—(97/10), February 4, 1997, as amended, decides that:

(a) Satisfactory assurances regarding the exceptional assistance to be provided under the enhanced HIPC Initiative by the Democratic Republic of the Congo’s other creditors continue to be in place, and

(b) The Trustee shall disburse to the Democratic Republic of the Congo as interim assistance the equivalent of SDR 45.66 million in the form of a grant that shall be paid no later than three business days after the adoption of this decision to an account for the benefit of the Democratic Republic of the Congo established and administered by the Trustee in accordance with Section III, paragraph 5 of the Trust Instrument; the proceeds of the grant shall be used by the Trustee to meet the Democratic Republic of the Congo's debt service payments on its existing debt to the Fund as they fall due, in accordance with the following schedule: 34.8 percent of eligible PRGF principal obligations falling due to the Fund for the period of twelve months from the date of this decision.

(c) For purposes of Section III, paragraph 3(d) of the Trust Instrument, the conditions for disbursement under (b) above are that, on the basis of information provided by the Democratic Republic of the Congo, the Democratic Republic of the Congo has met all of the conditions specified in the decision approving the PRGF arrangement for the Democratic Republic of the Congo (EBS/09/191, 12/1/09).

Table 1. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Selected Economic and Financial Indicators, 2007–14

	2007	2008 Prel.	2009 Est.	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014
	Projections							
(Annual percentage change; unless otherwise indicated)								
GDP and prices								
Real GDP	6.3	6.2	2.7	5.4	7.3	6.8	8.1	7.0
GDP deflator	17.8	19.4	30.3	23.4	12.8	9.8	8.3	8.4
Consumer prices, period average	16.7	18.0	45.0	24.7	13.5	10.5	9.0	8.8
Consumer prices, end-of-period	10.0	27.6	48.7	15.0	12.0	9.0	9.0	8.5
External sector								
Exports, f.o.b. (U.S.dollars)	109.6	7.2	-42.5	18.3	27.8	13.2	17.2	16.4
Imports, f.o.b. (U.S.\$ dollars)	81.8	27.6	-21.7	21.6	26.1	0.5	4.5	6.8
Export volume	75.0	-3.9	5.4	9.4	23.9	11.8	16.5	13.9
Import volume	69.0	15.8	-11.9	17.0	23.4	-1.4	2.5	4.9
Terms of trade	11.3	1.1	-38.6	4.1	0.9	-0.8	-1.4	0.3
Nominal effective exchange rate ¹	-15.5	-11.7	...	...	...	...	...	...
Real effective exchange rate ¹	-3.1	-0.7	...	...	...	...	...	...
Annual change in percent of beginning-of-period broad money; unless otherwise indicated)								
Money and credit								
Broad money	49.5	55.7	33.8	27.0	...	...	...	...
Net foreign assets	30.8	-6.0	-6.9	38.6	...	...	...	...
Net domestic assets	20.2	65.6	41.6	-11.2	...	...	...	...
Domestic credit	29.5	54.7	15.6	13.8	...	...	...	...
Of which:								
Net credit to government	10.3	11.3	-10.6	0.0	...	...	...	...
Credit to the private sector (annual percent change)	73.6	141.9	55.5	25.4	...	...	...	...
(Percent of GDP; unless otherwise indicated)								
Central government finance								
Total government revenue	14.8	18.5	18.0	17.9	19.0	20.2	20.8	21.2
Excluding signing bonus from the Sino-Congolese Cooperation Agreement	14.8	18.5	15.7	17.9	19.0	20.2	20.8	21.2
Grants	1.5	1.9	7.9	6.1	6.2	5.7	4.8	4.3
Total government expenditure ²	18.8	22.7	29.1	36.2	35.3	34.6	32.1	30.8
Underlying fiscal balance (cash basis)	0.8	0.9	-1.9	-0.5	-0.6	-0.4	0.4	0.4
Overall fiscal balance (payment order basis, incl. grants)	-2.5	-2.3	-3.2	-12.2	-10.1	-8.7	-6.4	-5.3
Overall fiscal balance (cash basis, incl. grants)	-3.1	-3.1	-4.8	-12.7	-10.8	-9.2	-6.2	-4.9
Investment and saving								
Gross national saving	16.7	6.1	7.0	5.8	5.6	7.4	11.2	14.4
Government	-1.0	-0.5	1.0	-0.1	1.8	2.9	3.8	4.2
Nongovernment	17.7	6.5	6.0	5.9	3.8	4.4	7.4	10.2
Investment	18.3	22.0	23.4	33.5	37.3	32.5	30.8	30.0
Government ³	2.4	3.7	9.3	18.0	17.9	17.1	15.1	13.8
Nongovernment	15.9	18.2	14.1	15.5	19.4	15.4	15.7	16.2
Balance of payments								
Exports of goods and services	65.5	61.3	41.8	42.7	49.0	50.8	53.9	57.2
Imports of goods and services	68.9	76.4	66.4	71.1	81.1	76.0	73.0	71.8
Current account balance, incl. transfers	-1.5	-15.9	-16.4	-27.7	-31.7	-25.1	-19.6	-15.6
Current account balance, excl. transfers	-9.0	-24.7	-30.4	-34.4	-37.7	-30.7	-24.6	-20.2
Current account balance, incl. transfers, after debt relief	3.0	-12.3	-13.0	-24.1	-27.3	-21.6	-16.8	-13.4
Gross official reserves (end-of-period, U.S.\$ millions of U.S. dollars)	180.6	77.8	1,039	1,223	1,314	1,511	1,769	1,919
Gross official reserves (weeks of nonaid-related imports of goods and services)	1.5	1.0	9.9	8.7	9.2	9.9	11.5	11.5
(Millions of U.S. dollars; unless otherwise indicated)								
External public debt								
Total stock, including IMF ⁴	13,425	13,149	12,785	4,329	5,386	6,434	6,882	7,761
Net present value (NPV) of debt ⁵	10,820	10,729	10,603	4,106	5,255	6,248	6,599	7,326
NPV of debt (percent of exports of goods and services) ⁵	264.5	189.7	175.5	73.8	98.9	100.8	90.9	88.0
Scheduled debt service	739.6	891.2	815.5	252.1	346.6	430.4	355.7	350.8
Percent of exports of goods and services	11.3	14.0	18.2	4.9	5.5	6.0	4.3	3.7
Percent of government revenue	45.6	37.8	29.4	8.8	10.6	11.8	9.0	8.2
Exchange rate, (Congo franc per U.S. dollar)								
Period average	516.0	563	...	...	...	...	...	...
End-of-period	503.0	639	...	...	...	...	...	...
Memorandum item:								
Nominal GDP (billions of Congo francs)	5,148	6,526	8,729	11,361	13,746	16,117	18,869	21,877

Sources: Congolese authorities; and IMF staff estimates and projections.

¹ Change in annual average. Minus sign indicates depreciation.

² Includes interest due before debt relief and expenditure financed by HIPC resources.

³ Includes investment financed by resources released under the enhanced HIPC Initiative.

⁴ End-of-period debt stock includes most of London Club debt (some US\$1.2 billion in 2008), which is expected to be bought back with deep discount grants from IDA, and accumulated arrears.

⁵ Estimates and projections are based on the 2009 DSA and after HIPC Initiative interim relief assistance. Includes assistance beyond the terms of the enhanced HIPC Initiative granted by some Paris Club creditors. Exports are on a three-year backward moving average; projections assume DRC reaches the HIPC completion point during the first half of 2010.

Table 2a. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Central Government Financial Operations, 2007–12

	2007	2008	2009		2010	2011	2012
		Prel.	Prog.	Est.	Projections		
(Billions of Congo francs; unless otherwise indicated)							
Total revenue and grants	837.0	1,326.8	2,363.6	2,253.1	2,729.2	3,464.1	4,172.9
Total revenue	761.0	1,205.3	1,554.3	1,565.7	2,031.1	2,605.0	3,247.8
Customs and excise	278.1	427.1	542.5	555.1	805.7	1,025.8	1,219.8
Direct and indirect taxes	259.9	430.7	557.0	557.0	733.7	982.4	1,353.9
Petroleum (royalties and taxes)	159.3	229.6	119.5	110.5	289.8	354.7	387.8
Administrative revenues	63.8	118.0	335.2	343.0	202.0	242.2	286.2
<i>Of which</i> : signing bonus for joint venture with China	0.0	0.0	195.2	199.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Total grants	76.0	121.5	809.4	687.4	698.1	859.1	925.1
Budget grants	0.0	0.0	231.2	237.6	0.0	0.0	0.0
Project grants	32.5	70.7	359.1	372.9	618.7	766.6	815.5
HIPC Initiative assistance ¹	43.5	50.8	219.1	76.9	79.5	92.5	109.6
Total expenditure	966.7	1,478.7	2,501.5	2,543.1	4,112.2	4,852.3	5,568.9
Current expenditure	800.5	1160.6	1,406.6	1,420.0	1857.0	2262.8	2712.8
Wages	301.0	452.2	547.6	547.6	758.2	924.2	1,083.7
Interest due	184.1	203.8	281.1	294.4	345.0	370.3	381.8
<i>Of which</i> : on external debt	155.4	169.5	248.2	261.5	308.9	303.4	307.9
Transfers and subsidies	111.7	226.9	260.9	260.9	346.8	416.2	497.1
Subsidies	6.2	15.7	15.0	15.0	31.5	26.9	28.5
Subordinated budgetary institutions	9.3	9.2	9.8	9.8	21.1	26.3	31.7
Transfers to provinces	49.7	125.0	142.6	142.6	185.6	224.5	263.3
Transfers to collection agencies	46.6	74.8	91.4	91.4	97.2	124.6	157.3
Scholarships	...	2.1	2.0	2.0	11.5	13.9	16.3
Goods and services	203.7	277.7	317.1	317.1	407.0	552.0	750.2
Capital expenditure	121.1	243.7	792.0	812.7	2,041.6	2,453.8	2,754.4
Foreign-financed	76.9	136.7	539.2	559.9	1,589.3	1,853.9	1,978.1
Domestic-financed	44.2	107.0	252.8	252.8	452.2	599.9	776.3
Government	44.2	107.0	141.3	141.3	105.6	127.7	149.8
Provinces	0.0	0.0	111.6	111.6	346.7	472.2	626.6
Exceptional expenditure ²	45.0	74.4	296.4	303.9	185.2	101.4	61.4
Foreign-financed	0.0	0.0	195.0	202.5	91.6	73.3	58.6
Domestic-financed	45.0	74.4	101.4	101.4	93.6	28.1	2.8
Budget Reserve	0.0	0.0	6.5	6.5	28.4	34.4	40.3
Overall fiscal balance (payment order basis)	-129.7	-151.9	-137.8	-289.9	-1,383.0	-1,388.2	-1,396.0
Underlying fiscal balance (payment order basis) ³	71.6	107.2	-61.6	-53.7	2.3	11.3	26.2
Domestic fiscal balance ⁴	26.6	32.8	-160.1	-152.4	-91.3	-16.8	23.4
Change in arrears (increase = +)	-11.3	-15.6	-49.9	-51.4	-28.0	-55.5	-50.0
Central bank operational result	-19.9	-35.8	-74.4	-74.4	-34.7	-34.7	-34.7
Overall fiscal balance (cash basis, before interest rescheduling)	-160.8	-203.3	-262.2	-415.7	-1,445.7	-1,478.4	-1,480.7
Underlying fiscal balance (cash basis)	40.5	55.8	-185.9	-179.5	-60.4	-78.9	-58.5
Domestic fiscal balance	-4.5	-18.6	-284.5	-278.2	-154.0	-106.9	-61.3
Total financing	160.8	203.3	262.2	415.7	1,445.7	1,478.4	1,480.7
Domestic financing	48.6	58.7	-70.6	-69.2	0.0	0.0	0.0
Banking system	44.1	72.7	-105.8	-105.8	0.0	0.0	0.0
Nonbank	4.4	-14.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Privatization receipts	...	0.0	35.3	36.6	...	...	...
Foreign financing	155.4	119.4	282.3	484.9	1,180.1	1,224.5	1,216.6
Amortization due before debt relief	-202.8	-249.7	-420.1	-346.5	-237.8	-297.2	-349.1
Exceptional Financing	0.0	0.0	827.0	0.0	1,497.7	0.0	0.0
Budget loans	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Project loans	60.9	51.8	398.3	413.6	1,090.8	1,203.0	1,261.4
Debt relief	39.5	42.8	27.8	62.6	327.2	318.8	304.2
Accumulation of external arrears (net, + increase)	257.7	274.5	-550.6	355.2	-1,497.7	0.0	0.0
Residual financing gap/errors and omissions	-43.1	25.3	50.40	0.00	265.6	253.9	264.2
<i>Memorandum items:</i>							
GDP (Billions of Congo francs)	5,148	6,526	8,729	8,729	11,361	13,746	16,117
Underlying fiscal balance (cash basis; excl. oil revenues) ³	-118.8	-173.8	-305.4	-290.1	-350.1	-433.5	-446.3
Total wage bill	301.0	452.2	547.6	547.6	758.2	924.2	1,083.7
Central government wage bill	301.0	452.2	547.6	367.0	516.9	628.8	737.3
Provincial government wage bill	...	0.0	0.0	180.5	241.3	295.4	346.4
Total goods and services	253.4	402.7	459.7	459.7	592.6	776.6	1,013.5
Central government goods and services	203.7	277.7	317.1	317.1	407.0	552.0	750.2
Provincial governments' non-wage expenditure	49.7	125.0	142.6	142.6	185.6	224.5	263.3
Domestically financed spending	765.5	1,223.9	1,637.0	1,638.5	2,156.6	2,677.6	3,268.7

Sources: Congolese authorities; and IMF staff estimates and projections.

¹ Reflects revised calculation of HIPC Initiative assistance on the basis of the 2009 Debt Sustainability Analysis.

² Exceptional expenditure includes spending for the Demobilization, Disarmament, and Reintegration (DDR) program, and cost of the elections.

³ Underlying fiscal balance is defined as revenue (excluding signing bonus from the SCCA) minus expenditure (excluding interest on foreign debt, foreign-financed capital expenditure, and all exceptional spending).

⁴ The domestic fiscal balance is defined as revenue (excluding the signing bonus from the SCCA) minus total expenditure (excluding interest on foreign debt, foreign-financed capital and exceptional expenditure).

Table 2b. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Central Government Financial Operations, 2007–12

	2007	2008	2009		2010	2011	2012
		Prel.	Prog.	Est.	Projections		
(Percent of GDP; unless otherwise indicated)							
Total revenue and grants	16.3	20.3	27.1	25.8	24.0	25.2	25.9
Total revenue	14.8	18.5	17.8	17.9	17.9	19.0	20.2
Customs and excise	5.4	6.5	6.2	6.4	7.1	7.5	7.6
Direct and indirect taxes	5.0	6.6	6.4	6.4	6.5	7.1	8.4
Petroleum (royalties and taxes)	3.1	3.5	1.4	1.3	2.6	2.6	2.4
Other	1.2	1.8	3.8	3.9	1.8	1.8	1.8
<i>Of which: Signing bonus from joint venture with China</i>	...	0.0	2.2	2.3	...	...	...
Total grants	1.5	1.9	9.3	7.9	6.1	6.2	5.7
Budget grants	0.0	0.0	2.6	2.7	0.0	0.0	0.0
Project grants	0.6	1.1	4.1	4.3	5.4	5.6	5.1
HIPC Initiative assistance ¹	0.8	0.8	2.5	0.9	0.7	0.7	0.7
Total expenditure	18.8	22.7	28.7	29.1	36.2	35.3	34.6
Current expenditure	15.5	17.8	16.1	16.3	16.3	16.5	16.8
Wages	5.8	6.9	6.3	6.3	6.7	6.7	6.7
Interest due	3.6	3.1	3.2	3.4	3.0	2.7	2.4
<i>Of which: On external debt</i>	3.0	2.6	2.8	3.0	2.7	2.2	1.9
Transfers and subsidies	2.2	3.5	3.0	3.0	3.1	3.0	3.1
Subsidies	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.3	0.2	0.2
Subordinated budgetary institutions	0.2	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.2
Transfers to provinces	1.0	1.9	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.6
Transfers to collection agencies	0.9	1.1	1.0	1.0	0.9	0.9	1.0
Goods and services	4.0	4.3	3.6	3.6	3.6	4.0	4.7
Capital expenditure	2.4	3.7	9.1	9.3	18.0	17.9	17.1
Foreign-financed	1.5	2.1	6.2	6.4	14.0	13.5	12.3
Domestic-financed	0.9	1.6	2.9	2.9	4.0	4.4	4.8
Exceptional expenditure ²	0.9	1.1	3.4	3.5	1.6	0.7	0.4
Foreign-financed	0.0	0.0	2.2	2.3	0.8	0.5	0.4
Domestic-financed	0.9	1.1	1.2	1.2	0.8	0.2	0.0
Budget Reserve	0.0	0.0	0.1	0.1	0.3	0.3	0.3
Overall fiscal balance (payment order basis)	-2.5	-2.3	-1.6	-3.3	-12.2	-10.1	-8.7
Underlying fiscal balance (payment order basis) ³	1.4	1.6	-0.7	-0.6	0.0	0.1	0.2
Domestic fiscal balance ⁴	0.5	0.5	-1.8	-1.7	-0.8	-0.1	0.1
Change in arrears (increase = +)	-0.2	-0.2	-0.6	-0.6	-0.2	-0.4	-0.3
Central bank operational result	-0.4	-0.5	-0.9	-0.9	-0.3	-0.3	-0.2
Overall fiscal balance (cash basis, before interest rescheduling)	-3.1	-3.1	-3.0	-4.8	-12.7	-10.8	-9.2
Underlying fiscal balance (cash basis) ³	0.8	0.9	-2.1	-2.1	-0.5	-0.6	-0.4
Domestic fiscal balance ⁴	-0.1	-0.3	-3.3	-3.2	-1.4	-0.8	-0.4
Total financing	3.1	3.1	3.0	4.8	12.7	10.8	9.2
Domestic financing	0.9	0.9	-0.8	-0.8	0.0	0.0	0.0
Banking system	0.9	1.1	-1.2	-1.2	0.0	0.0	0.0
Nonbank	0.1	-0.2	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Privatization receipts	...	0.0	0.4	0.4	...	...	...
Foreign financing	3.0	1.8	3.2	5.6	10.4	8.9	7.5
Amortization due before debt relief	-3.9	-3.8	-4.8	-4.0	-2.1	-2.2	-2.2
Exceptional Financing	0.0	0.0	9.5	0.0	13.2	0.0	0.0
Budget loans	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Project loans	1.2	0.8	4.6	4.7	9.6	8.8	7.8
Debt relief	0.8	0.7	0.3	0.7	2.9	2.3	1.9
Accumulation of external arrears	5.0	4.2	-6.3	4.1	-13.2	0.0	0.0
Residual financing gap	-0.8	0.4	0.6	0.0	2.3	1.8	1.6
<i>Memorandum items:</i>							
GDP (billions of Congo francs)	5,148	6,526	8,729	8,729	11,361	13,746	16,117
Underlying fiscal balance (cash basis; excl. oil revenues) ³	-2.3	-2.7	-3.5	-3.3	-3.1	-3.2	-2.8
Total wage bill	5.8	6.9	6.3	6.3	6.7	6.7	6.7
Central government wage bill	5.8	6.9	6.3	4.2	4.5	4.6	4.6
Provincial government wage bill	...	...	0.0	2.1	2.1	2.1	2.1
Total goods and services	4.9	6.2	5.3	5.3	5.2	5.6	6.3
Central government goods and services	4.0	4.3	3.6	3.6	3.6	4.0	4.7
Provincial governments' non-wage expenditure	1.0	1.9	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.6	1.6

Sources: Congolese authorities; and IMF staff estimates and projections.

¹Reflects revised calculation of HIPC Initiative assistance on the basis of 2009 Debt Sustainability Analysis.

²Exceptional expenditure includes spending for the Demobilization, Disarmament, and Reintegration (DDR) program, and cost of the elections.

³Underlying fiscal balance is defined as revenue (excluding signing bonus from the SCCA) minus expenditure (excluding interest on foreign debt, foreign-financed capital, and all exceptional spending).

⁴The domestic fiscal balance is defined as revenue (excluding the signing bonus from the SCCA) minus total expenditure (excluding interest on foreign debt, foreign-financed capital and exceptional expenditure).

Table 3a. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Monetary Survey, 2007–10
(At current exchange rates)

	2007 Dec	2008 Dec	2009		2010 Dec Proj
			Sep Prel	Dec Est.	
(Billions of Congo francs)					
Net foreign assets	-172.6	-211.0	-219.8	-279.7	235.8
Net domestic assets	831.4	1252.4	1544.0	1668.2	1518.3
Domestic credit	373.4	724.3	812.6	880.3	1065.1
Net credit to government	176.2	248.9	199.0	143.1	143.1
Credit to the private sector	195.2	472.3	593.7	734.1	920.3
Credit to parastatals	1.9	3.1	20.0	3.1	1.7
Other items, net (including valuation change)	458.1	528.1	731.4	787.8	453.2
Broad money (M2)	641.2	998.4	1286.9	1335.5	1696.2
Narrow money (M1)	300.3	392.5	411.5	436.8	530.5
Currency in circulation	233.3	304.6	331.5	354.5	435.9
Demand deposits	67.0	87.9	80.0	82.3	94.6
Quasi money	341.0	606.0	875.3	898.8	1165.7
Time deposits in domestic currency	2.5	1.3	3.4	4.7	13.5
Foreign currency deposits	338.5	604.7	872.0	894.0	1152.2
Import deposits	17.6	42.9	37.3	52.9	57.9
(Year-on year change in percent)					
Net foreign assets	43.4	-22.2	-74.5	-32.6	184.3
Net domestic assets	11.6	50.6	50.0	33.2	-9.0
Domestic credit	51.3	94.0	53.1	21.5	21.0
Net credit to government	33.4	41.2	36.3	-42.5	0.0
Credit to the private sector	73.6	141.9	55.6	55.5	25.4
Credit to parastatals	-11.8	63.4	540.4	0.0	-45.6
Other items, net (including valuation change)	-8.1	15.3	46.7	49.2	-42.5
Broad money (M2)	49.5	55.7	46.6	33.8	27.0
Narrow money (M1)	41.2	30.7	26.9	11.3	21.4
Currency in circulation	28.2	30.6	27.6	16.4	23.0
Demand deposits	117.6	31.2	23.9	-6.4	14.8
Quasi money	57.8	77.7	58.2	48.3	29.7
Time deposits in domestic currency	483.0	-47.8	80.1	262.0	185.9
Foreign currency deposits	56.9	78.6	58.2	47.9	28.9
Import deposits	54.0	144.0	44.5	23.3	9.4
(Annual change in percent of beginning-of-period broad money)					
Net foreign assets	30.8	-6.0	-0.9	-6.9	38.6
Net domestic assets	20.2	65.6	29.2	41.6	-11.2
Domestic credit	29.5	54.7	8.8	15.6	13.8
Net credit to government	10.3	11.3	-5.0	-10.6	0.0
Credit to the private sector	19.3	43.2	12.2	26.2	13.9
Credit to parastatals	-0.1	0.2	1.7	0.0	-0.1
Other items, net (including valuation change)	-9.4	10.9	20.4	26.0	-25.1
Broad money (M2)	49.5	55.7	28.9	33.8	27.0
Narrow money (M1)	20.4	14.4	1.9	4.4	7.0
Currency in circulation	12.0	11.1	2.7	5.0	6.1
Demand deposits	8.4	3.3	-0.8	-0.6	0.9
Quasi money	29.1	41.3	27.0	29.3	20.0
Time deposits in domestic currency	0.5	-0.2	0.2	0.3	0.7
Foreign currency deposits	28.6	41.5	26.8	29.0	19.3
Import deposits	1.4	4.0	-0.6	1.0	0.4
Memorandum items:					
Nominal GDP (billions of Congo francs)	5,148	6,526	...	8,729	11,361.3
Velocity (GDP/broad money)	8.0	6.5	...	6.5	6.7
Foreign currency deposits (percent of M2)	52.8	60.6	67.8	66.9	67.9
Foreign currency deposits (percent of total deposits)	83.0	87.1	91.3	91.1	91.4

Sources: Congolese authorities; and IMF staff estimates and projections.

Table 3b. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Accounts of the Central Bank of the Congo, 2007–10
(At current exchange rates)

	2007	2008	2009		2010
	Dec	Dec	Sep Prel	Dec Est.	Dec Proj
(Billions of Congo francs)					
Net foreign assets	-333.3	-390.1	-620.0	-515.4	-80.4
Net domestic assets	621.7	773.8	1027.5	974.2	640.1
Domestic credit	206.6	295.2	298.0	230.5	231.1
Net credit to government	198.7	272.4	232.9	166.6	166.6
Credit to the private sector	3.485	3.0	7.1	3.0	3.0
Credit to parastatals	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Claims on deposit money banks	4.4	19.7	58.0	60.9	61.4
Other items, net	415.1	478.6	729.4	743.7	409.0
Of which: BTR	32.9	47.0	56.9	81.9	98.8
Base money	288.5	383.7	407.5	458.7	559.7
Narrow base money	283.6	378.1	400.0	453.1	554.1
Currency in circulation	243.8	320.3	352.9	367.5	453.9
In bank vaults	10.5	15.7	21.4	13.0	18.0
Outside banks	233.3	304.6	331.5	354.5	435.9
Deposits at the central bank	38.7	56.2	43.8	84.1	98.6
Private sector deposits	0.6	0.9	1.6	0.9	0.9
Parastatal deposits	0.4	0.7	1.7	0.7	0.7
Foreign currency deposits	1.9	2.7	3.5	2.7	2.7
Import deposits	3.0	2.9	4.0	2.9	2.9
(Year-on year change in percent)					
Net foreign assets	23.1	-17.0	-87.9	-32.1	84.4
Net domestic assets	-3.6	24.5	55.9	25.9	-34.3
Domestic credit	15.5	42.9	46.6	-21.9	0.3
Net credit to government	21.8	37.1	28.0	-38.8	0.0
Credit to the private sector	279.1	-13.1	36.2	0.0	0.0
Credit to parastatals	-48.5	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Claims on deposit money banks	-70.2	347.7	258.9	208.7	1.0
Other items, net	-10.9	15.3	60.0	55.4	-45.0
Base money	36.5	33.0	23.8	19.6	22.0
Narrow base money	38.9	33.3	23.2	19.8	22.3
Currency in circulation	31.5	31.4	24.4	14.7	23.5
In bank vaults	205.4	49.1	-10.2	-17.3	38.6
Outside banks	28.2	30.6	27.6	16.4	23.0
Deposits at the central bank	110.4	45.2	11.1	49.5	17.3
Private sector deposits	426.3	48.5	312.0	0.0	0.0
Parastatal deposits	101.8	62.6	39.8	0.0	0.0
Foreign currency deposits	-56.0	39.0	72.6	0.0	0.0
Import deposits	5.0	-1.7	58.7	0.0	0.0
(Annual change in percent of beginning-of-period base money)					
Net foreign assets	47.5	-19.7	-59.9	-32.7	94.8
Net domestic assets	-11.0	52.7	66.1	52.2	-72.8
Domestic credit	13.2	30.7	0.7	-16.9	0.1
Net credit to government	16.8	25.6	-10.3	-27.6	0.0
Credit to the private sector	1.2	-0.2	1.1	0.0	0.0
Credit to parastatals	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Claims on deposit money banks	-4.9	5.3	10.0	10.7	0.1
Other items, net	-24.1	22.0	65.4	69.1	-73.0
Base money	36.5	33.0	6.2	19.6	22.0
Narrow base money	37.6	32.8	5.7	19.6	22.0
Currency in circulation	27.7	26.5	8.5	12.3	18.8
In bank vaults	3.4	1.8	1.5	-0.7	1.1
Outside banks	24.3	24.7	7.0	13.0	17.8
Deposits at the central bank	9.6	6.1	-3.2	7.3	3.2
Private sector deposits	0.2	0.1	0.2	0.0	0.0
Parastatal deposits	0.1	0.1	0.3	0.0	0.0
Foreign currency deposits	-1.2	0.3	0.2	0.0	0.0
Import deposits	0.1	0.0	0.3	0.0	0.0

Sources: Congolese authorities; and IMF staff estimates and projections.

Table 4. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Balance of Payments Summary, 2007–14

	2007	2008 Prel.	2009 Est.	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014
				Projections				
	(Millions of dollars; unless otherwise indicated)							
Current account	-153	-1,840	-1,760	-3,305	-4,115	-3,528	-3,011	-2,606
Merchandise trade	886	-125	-1,467	-1,907	-2,330	-1,620	-870	-204
Exports, f.o.b.	6,143	6,585	3,787	4,480	5,727	6,481	7,594	8,836
Of which: mining products	5,108	5,422	3,076	3,639	4,788	5,494	6,550	7,569
Imports, f.o.b.	-5,257	-6,711	-5,254	-6,388	-8,057	-8,101	-8,465	-9,040
Of which: aid-related imports	-739	-1,109	-1,538	-1,573	-1,597	-1,573	-1,451	-1,431
Services	-1,225	-1,624	-1,169	-1,496	-1,843	-1,914	-2,063	-2,240
Receipts	392	522	695	618	631	660	682	708
Expenditure	-1,618	-2,146	-1,864	-2,115	-2,474	-2,573	-2,745	-2,947
Of which: aid-related imports	-230	-205	-551	-560	-427	-423	-386	-384
Income	-635	-1,321	-745	-782	-811	-880	-969	-1,069
Receipts	26	27	27	27	30	31	33	36
Expenditure	-661	-1,349	-772	-809	-841	-911	-1,002	-1,105
Of which: interest payments ¹	-367	-366	-326	-297	-291	-272	-258	-243
Current transfers	821	1,231	1,621	880	869	885	891	907
Of which: official aid	740	1,019	1,499	805	781	784	772	763
Capital and financial account	66	1,266	1,347	2,845	3,492	3,071	2,760	2,307
Capital account	18	145	375	435	518	521	490	490
Official	92	223	458	524	615	624	600	608
Private	-74	-78	-84	-89	-97	-103	-110	-118
Financial account	49	1,121	972	2,410	2,974	2,550	2,270	1,816
Official capital	-96	-315	-23	904	919	855	312	434
Gross disbursements	294	102	513	1,148	1,136	1,099	945	931
Scheduled amortization ²	-390	-417	-536	-243	-217	-244	-273	-299
Private capital (net)	145	1,435	995	1,505	2,055	1,695	1,959	1,382
Of which: Foreign direct investment	374	1,713	626	786	1,119	1,026	965	1,050
Other Private non-banking sector (net) ³	-229	-277	369	719	936	669	993	332
Balance before errors and omissions	-87	-574	-413	-461	-623	-457	-251	-299
Errors and omissions	-262	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Overall balance	-349	-574	-413	-461	-623	-457	-251	-299
Financing	-99	158	-31	-1,972	-345	-415	-295	-191
Net change in non-Fund arrears ⁴	163	171	197	-1,576	0	0	0	0
Net banking sector reserves (increase = -)	-262	-13	-228	-397	-345	-415	-295	-191
Central bank	-199	-52	-244	-347	-263	-304	-295	-191
Of which: net Fund credit	-62	-137	51	-164	-172	-107	-37	-41
Commercial banks	-63	39	16	-49	-82	-111	0	0
Financing need before exceptional assistance	-448	-416	-444	-2,433	-968	-873	-546	-490
Exceptional financing	448	416	368	1,999	574	489	431	372
Consolidation of arrears	0	0	0	1,576	0	0	0	0
Debt relief ⁵	448	416	368	424	574	489	431	372
Residual financing need (overfinancing = +)	0	0	-76	-433	-394	-384	-116	-118
	(Percent of GDP, unless otherwise indicated)							
Memorandum items:								
Debt service after debt relief (percent of exports of goods and services)	1.4	1.5	1.5	1.6	2.7	2.7	2.3	2.0
Current account balance (including official transfers, but before debt relief)	-1.5	-15.9	-16.4	-27.7	-31.7	-25.1	-19.6	-15.6
Current account balance (excluding official transfers and debt relief)	-9.0	-24.7	-30.4	-34.4	-37.7	-30.7	-24.6	-20.2
Current account balance (including official transfers and debt relief)	3.0	-12.3	-13.0	-24.1	-27.3	-21.6	-16.8	-13.4
Current account balance (excluding official transfers, but including debt relief)	-4.5	-21.1	-27.0	-30.8	-33.3	-27.2	-21.8	-18.0
Gross official reserves (in millions of U.S. dollars)	180.6	77.8	1,039.3	1,222.6	1,314.1	1,511.2	1,768.9	1,919.0
Weeks of non-aid-related imports of goods and services	1.5	1.0	9.9	8.7	9.2	9.9	11.5	11.5

Sources: Congolese authorities; and IMF staff estimates and projections.

¹ Including interest due to the IMF.

² Excluding repayments to the IMF.

³ Including unrecorded transactions. The latter may be substantial given weaknesses in statistics.

⁴ Mainly arrears to Paris Club creditors.

⁵ Assumes HIPC Completion point and MDRI during the first half of 2010.

Table 5. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Tentative Schedule of Disbursements and Reviews Under the PRGF Arrangement, 2009–12

Date	Disbursement	Conditions
December 11, 2009	SDR 49.493 million	Executive Board Approval.
May 31, 2010	SDR 49.493 million	Completion of first review, based on observance of performance criteria at end-December 2009.
December 31, 2010	SDR 49.493 million	Completion of second review, based on observance of performance criteria at end-June 2010.
May 31, 2011	SDR 49.493 million	Completion of third review, based on observance of performance criteria at end-December 2010.
December 31, 2011	SDR 49.493 million	Completion of fourth review, based on observance of performance criteria at end-June 2011.
May 31, 2012	SDR 49.493 million	Completion of fifth review, based on observance of performance criteria at end-December 2011.
December 15, 2012	SDR 49.492 million	Completion of sixth review, based on observance of performance criteria at end-June 2012.

Table 6. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Indicators of Capacity to Repay the Fund, 2009–22

	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022
Fund obligations based on existing credit														
(In millions of SDRs)	99.6	107.7	112.5	70.0	25.1	27.6	32.8	27.3	27.2	27.0	13.6	0.3	0.3	0.3
Principal	97.3	105.4	110.7	68.7	24.0	26.7	32.0	26.7	26.7	26.7	13.3	0.0	0.0	0.0
Charges and interest ¹	2.3	2.4	1.8	1.3	1.1	1.0	0.8	0.7	0.5	0.4	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3
Fund obligations based on prospective credit ²														
(In millions of SDRs)	0.0	0.5	1.0	1.5	1.7	1.7	16.6	36.3	55.8	70.4	70.0	54.8	34.8	14.9
Principal	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	14.9	34.7	54.4	69.3	69.3	54.4	34.6	14.9
Charges and interest	0.0	0.5	1.0	1.5	1.7	1.7	1.7	1.6	1.4	1.1	0.7	0.4	0.2	0.0
Total obligations on existing and prospective credit ¹														
(In millions of SDRs)	99.6	108.2	113.5	71.4	26.8	29.4	49.4	63.6	83.0	97.4	83.6	55.1	35.1	15.2
(In millions of U.S. dollars)	152.7	168.4	176.3	110.9	41.6	45.5	76.4	98.4	128.5	150.8	129.5	85.3	54.3	23.5
In percent of exports of goods and NFS	3.4	3.3	2.8	1.5	0.5	0.5	0.7	0.8	1.0	1.1	0.9	0.5	0.3	0.1
In percent of GDP	1.4	1.4	1.4	0.8	0.3	0.3	0.4	0.5	0.6	0.7	0.5	0.3	0.2	0.1
In percent of quota	18.7	20.3	21.3	13.4	5.0	5.5	9.3	11.9	15.6	18.3	15.7	10.3	6.6	2.8
In percent of gross international reserves	14.7	13.8	13.4	7.3	2.4	2.4	3.9	4.8	5.8	6.1	4.8	2.9	1.7	0.7
Fund credit outstanding (end-period)														
In millions of SDRs	510.2	503.8	492.1	522.4	498.4	471.7	424.9	363.6	282.5	186.6	103.9	49.5	14.9	0.0
In millions of U.S. dollars	781.7	784.2	764.6	811.1	773.2	730.5	657.9	563.0	437.4	288.9	160.9	76.6	23.0	0.0
In percent of exports of goods and NFS	17.3	15.3	12.0	11.3	9.3	7.6	6.1	4.6	3.3	2.0	1.1	0.5	0.1	0.0
In percent of GDP	7.3	6.6	5.9	5.8	5.0	4.4	3.6	2.9	2.1	1.3	0.7	0.3	0.1	0.0
In percent of quota	95.7	94.5	92.3	98.0	93.5	88.5	79.7	68.2	53.0	35.0	19.5	9.3	2.8	0.0
In percent of total external debt	6.1	5.1	4.5	4.4	4.0	3.6	3.1	2.6	2.0	1.3	0.8	0.4	0.1	0.0
In percent of gross international reserves	75.2	64.1	58.2	53.7	43.7	38.1	33.5	27.2	19.6	11.6	0.1	0.0	0.0	0.0
(Millions of U.S. dollars, unless otherwise indicated)														
Memorandum items														
Exports of goods and services (in millions of U.S. dollars)	4,509	5,126	6,388	7,172	8,310	9,580	10,853	12,204	13,236	14,167	15,160	16,083	16,988	17,911
Quota (in millions of SDRs)	533	533	533	533	533	533	533	533	533	533	533	533	533	533
Gross international reserves (in millions of U.S. dollars)	1,039	1,223	1,314	1,511	1,769	1,919	1,965	2,069	2,233	2,491	2,684	2,908	3,144	3,403

Sources: IMF staff estimates and projections

¹ Upon the effectiveness of the amendments to the PRGT instrument, there is a temporary interest waiver through end-2011 on PRGF outstanding obligations and drawings.

² Includes prospective disbursement under the PRGF of SDR 346.45 million

**Table 7. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Progress Status of HIPC Completion Point Triggers
(As of October 31, 2009)**

Triggers	Progress status
1. PRSP	
Completion of a full PRSP through a participatory process and its implementation for one year, duly documented in the DRC's annual progress report.	DRC's full PRSP (2006–08) was (a) completed through a participatory process, (b) adopted by the government in July 2006, (c) endorsed by the democratically-elected government in March 2007, and (d) submitted to the Bank and the IMF. A priority action plan (PAP1) for the implementation of the PRSP (July 2007–December 2008) was adopted in July 2007 and an updated priority action plan (PAP2) for 2009–10 was adopted in 2009. Monitoring of the PRSP implementation suggests that little progress has been made in the social sectors and that many PRSP objectives will not be met. The government has decided to extend the PRSP through 2010, due to early delays in the beginning of its implementation. Preparation of a new PRSP (2011–15) began in June 2009.
2. Macroeconomic stability	
Continued maintenance of macroeconomic stability after reaching the decision point, as evidenced by satisfactory performance in a program supported by an arrangement under the IMF's PRGF.	After unsatisfactory performance on the first PRGF, the government embarked on a series of staff monitored programs (SMPs) from April 2006 through June 2009. Satisfactory completion of the first review of a new PRGF-supported program will be necessary.
3. Use of budgetary savings resulting from enhanced HIPC Initiative-related debt service relief during the interim period for poverty-related expenditures in accordance with the I-PRSP, with supporting documentation satisfactory to the staffs of IDA and the IMF.	Initially a special HIPC account was set up but it has not been used in recent years. The authorities plan to assess poverty-related expenditure as defined in the PRSP in comparison with other expenditures. The results of this approach are expected in early 2010.
4. Public expenditure management	
(a) Implementation of a modernized budget-execution system, providing information from commitment to payment, and making it possible to monitor of arrears;	(a) A new budget-execution system has been introduced in 2003 provides a reasonable amount of information on expenditure tracking (<i>Chaîne de la dépense</i>). Budget execution reports (<i>États de suivi budgétaire - ESB</i>) are produced although they need improvements. Additionally, there are considerable delays in producing ESB harmonized with the state financial operations table (<i>Tableau des opérations financières de l'État - TOFE</i>). Sectoral budget execution reports are prepared by line ministries and sent to the Ministry of Budget but are not exhaustive.

Table 7. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Progress Status of Trigger for Reaching the HIPC Completion Point (Continued)

Triggers	Progress status
(b) adoption and implementation of a double-entry government accounting system and a new chart of accounts; and	(b) The double-entry system is in place. Staff have been trained, equipment purchased, and software developed. However, treasury accounts produced from the system are not exhaustive or fully reliable.
(c) production of quarterly budget execution reports using economic, administrative, and functional classifications.	(c) A new classification has been adopted. Budgetary reports are produced using economic, administrative, and functional classifications, but with a lag of two to three months.
5. Governance and service delivery in priority sectors	
(a) Completion of a budget-tracking exercise of health, education, rural development and infrastructure expenditure, consisting of (i) monitoring the execution of poverty-related expenditure; (ii) evaluation by user groups of the quality of related public services, and (iii) evaluation by service-providers of constraints to effective provision; and	(a) The Treasury monitors poverty-related public expenditures in all sectors, using the new budget classifications. The evaluation by user groups of health clinics and schools and the evaluation by service providers in education and health were conducted in 2005 through an Institutional and Governance Review with World Bank support. Another survey of users on the quality of service delivery was launched in April 2009, with results expected in December 2009.
(b) Adoption and implementation of a new procurement code and key implementing decrees.	(b) The draft procurement code and its implementing laws were adopted by the government and in December 2008 submitted to Parliament which is expected to be adopted by year-end 2009. Institutions to operationalize the new code will be established.
6. Social and rural sectors	
Adoption of sectoral development strategies and related implementation plans for health, education and rural development, that are satisfactory to IDA.	The country health status report (RESP) was issued in May 2005 and led to the completion of the Health Sector Strategy in March 2006. This strategy will be updated during late in 2009.
	The Status Report on the National Education System was finalized in September 2004. An outline of the sector strategy was drafted in 2006 and integrated into the full PRSP. Technical work to identify priorities for reform of the sector was conducted by independent commissions and finalized in 2008. The World Bank is currently reviewing the draft strategy for the primary and secondary education subsector. A note on the development on higher education strategy is expected to be completed by April 2010.
	An Agriculture Sector Strategy that was finalized in September 2007 has yet to be validated and adopted.

Table 7. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Progress Status of Trigger for Reaching the HIPC Completion Point (Concluded)

Triggers	Progress status
7. Debt management	
Installation and full activation of a computerized debt-recording system, covering public and publicly-guaranteed debt that can (a) produce monthly debt-service projections, and incorporate actual disbursement and debt-service payment execution data; (b) produce advance monthly debt-service projections that will be published quarterly; and (c) support the centralization of debt information into a single center.	Debt management software (SYGADE) was installed, external debt outstanding recorded, and the implementation program, including the training of relevant staff for debt management, completed. In 2008 the OGEDEP issued the first statistical report on public debt as of end-December 2007 using SYGADE. The final report was due in April 2009 but has not yet been released. A Prime Ministerial decree strengthening the role of OGEDEP as the single center for debt information was signed in February 2008. The related action plan for OGEDEP was validated by the Minister of Finance in May 2008, but implementation is yet to be effected.

Sources: World Bank and IMF staff based on information from Congolese authorities.

DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC OF THE CONGO

Three-Year Arrangement under the Poverty Reduction and Growth Facility

Attached hereto is a letter (the “Letter”) dated November 30, 2009, with its attached Memorandum on Economic and Financial Policies (the “Memorandum”) and Technical Memorandum of Understanding (the “TMU”), from the Prime Minister of the Democratic Republic of the Congo, requesting from the International Monetary Fund, as Trustee (the “Trustee”) of the Poverty Reduction and Growth Facility and Exogenous Shock Facility (“PRGF-ESF Trust), a three-year arrangement under the Poverty Reduction and Growth Facility (“PRGF”), and setting forth:

- (a) the objectives and policies of the program that the authorities of the Democratic Republic of the Congo intend to pursue during the three-year period of the arrangement;
- (b) the objectives, policies and measures that the authorities of the Democratic Republic of the Congo intend to pursue during the first year of the arrangement; and
- (c) understandings of the Democratic Republic of the Congo with the Trustee regarding reviews that will be made of progress in realizing the objectives of the program and of the policies and measures that the authorities of the Democratic Republic of the Congo will pursue for the second and third years of the arrangement.

To support these objectives and policies, the Trustee grants the requested three-year arrangement in accordance with the following provisions, and subject to the provisions applying to assistance under the PRGF-ESF Trust.

1. (a) For a period of three years from the date on which the arrangement becomes effective, the Democratic Republic of the Congo will have the right to obtain disbursements from the Trustee in a total amount equivalent to SDR 346.45 million, subject to the availability of resources in the PRGF-ESF Trust.
 - (b) Disbursements under this arrangement shall not exceed the equivalent of SDR 98.986 million until the beginning of the second year of the arrangement and the equivalent SDR 197.972 million until the beginning of the third year of the arrangement.
2. During the period of the arrangement:
 - (a) the first disbursement, in an amount equivalent to SDR 49.493 million, will be available upon effectiveness of the arrangement, at the request of the Democratic Republic of the Congo;

- (b) the second disbursement, in an amount equivalent to SDR 49.493 million, will be available on or after May 31, 2010, at the request of the Democratic Republic of the Congo and subject to paragraphs 4 and 5 below;
 - (c) the third disbursement, in an amount equivalent to SDR 49.493 million, will be available on or after December 31, 2010, at the request of the Democratic Republic of the Congo and subject to paragraphs 4 and 5 below;
- 3. The right to request disbursements during the second and third years of this arrangement shall be subject to such phasing and conditions as shall be determined in the context of reviews under the Democratic Republic of the Congo's PRGF arrangement.
- 4. The Democratic Republic of the Congo shall not request disbursements specified in paragraph 2 above:
 - (a) if the Managing Director of the Trustee finds that with respect to the second disbursement specified in paragraph 2(b) above, the data as of December 31, 2009, and with respect to the third disbursement specified in paragraph 2(c) above, indicate that:
 - (i) the floor on net foreign assets of the Central Bank of the Congo (the "BCC"), or
 - (ii) the ceiling on net domestic assets of the BCC, or
 - (iii) the ceiling on net bank credit to the government,as specified in Table I.1 of the Memorandum and as further specified in the TMU, was not observed.
 - (b) Until the Trustee has determined, with respect to the second disbursement, that the first review, and with respect to the third disbursement the second review of the Democratic Republic of the Congo's program referred to in paragraph 8 of the Letter has been completed.
- 5. The Democratic Republic of the Congo will not request any disbursement under this arrangement:
 - (a) If, at any time during this arrangement, the government of the Democratic Republic of the Congo, including the local governments and the BCC, contracts or guarantees new nonconcessional external debt with original maturity or more than one year as specified in Table I.1 of the Memorandum, and further specified in the TMU; or
 - (b) If at any time during this arrangement, the government of the Democratic Republic of the Congo, including the local governments and the BCC, contracts or guarantees new nonconcessional external debt with original maturity of up to one year as specified in Table I.1 of the Memorandum, and further specified in the TMU; or

- (c) If at any time during this arrangement, the BCC processes payments of government expenditures (including those urgent in nature) without authorization according to proper budgetary procedures by the ministries of finance and budget as specified in Table I.1 of the Memorandum, and further specified in the TMU; or
- (d) If at any time during this arrangement, the Democratic Republic of the Congo accumulates new external payments arrears, as specified in Table I.1 of the Memorandum, and further specified in the TMU; or
- (e) If at any time during this arrangement, the Democratic Republic of the Congo has:
 - (i) imposed or intensified restrictions on payments and transfers for current international transactions; or
 - (ii) introduced or modified multiple currency practices, or
 - (iii) concluded bilateral payments agreements that are inconsistent with Article VIII; or
 - (iv) imposed or intensified import restrictions for balance of payments reasons; or

(f) Until the Trustee has determined that, for each such disbursement, so long as the Democratic Republic of the Congo has outstanding sovereign external payments arrears to private creditors, or by virtue of the Democratic Republic of the Congo's imposition of exchange controls there are outstanding non-sovereign external payments arrears, a financing assurances review is completed;

6. When the Democratic Republic of the Congo is prevented from requesting any disbursement under this arrangement because of paragraphs 4 and 5 above, such disbursements may be made available only after consultation has taken place between the Trustee and the Democratic Republic of the Congo and understandings have been reached regarding the circumstances in which the Democratic Republic of the Congo may request that and any further disbursements.

7. In accordance with paragraph 3 of the Letter, the Democratic Republic of the Congo will provide the Trustee with such information as the Trustee requests in connection with the progress of the Democratic Republic of the Congo in implementing the policies and reaching the objectives of the program supported by this arrangement.

8. During the period of this arrangement, the Democratic Republic of the Congo shall remain in close consultation with the Trustee in accordance with paragraph [7] of the Letter, [and] the Democratic Republic of the Congo shall consult with the Trustee on the adoption of any measures that may be appropriate at the initiative of the government or whenever the Managing Director of the Trustee requests such a consultation. Moreover, after the period of this arrangement and while the Democratic Republic of the Congo has outstanding financial

obligations to the Trustee arising from loan disbursements under this arrangement, the Democratic Republic of the Congo will consult with the Trustee from time to time, at the initiative of the government or whenever the Managing Director of the Trustee requests consultation on the Democratic Republic of the Congo's economic and financial policies. These consultations may include correspondence and visits of officials of the Trustee to the Democratic Republic of the Congo or of representatives of the Democratic Republic of the Congo to the Trustee.

APPENDIX I
TRANSLATED FROM FRENCH

DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC OF THE CONGO
LETTER OF INTENT

Kinshasa, November 30, 2009

Mr. Dominique Strauss-Kahn
Managing Director
The International Monetary Fund
Washington, D.C. 20431
United States of America

Mr. Strauss-Kahn:

As you know, since 2001 the Democratic Republic of the Congo has made progress on both the political and economic fronts. Indeed, during the period, the government has taken important steps toward establishing democracy, restoring peace, and fostering national reconciliation. On the economic front, prudent policies and reforms helped rekindle economic growth and tame hyperinflation.

The main obstacles that continue to affect economic recovery, despite progress in the pacification of the eastern provinces, are the continued periodic episodes of instability created by certain pockets of resistance. This situation has slowed down the implementation of our development agenda and put a severe burden on our limited budgetary resources. Economic recovery is also constrained by the lack to adequate infrastructure: dilapidated roads and railways, insufficient social infrastructure especially hospitals and schools, with negative consequences for human capital.

Most recently, despite the difficult circumstances brought on by the global financial crisis, we have persevered in implementing sound policies in the context of our economic program for the period January–June 2009 which was monitored by IMF staff. Notwithstanding the significant revenue shortfalls caused by weak mining activity and the high levels of security-related spending on account of the conflict in the eastern provinces, the government was able to abstain from recourse to central bank financing while building up its gross foreign reserves, broadly in line with the objectives of the staff monitored program. This was greatly facilitated by the assistance provided by the IMF through the Rapid-Access Component of its Exogenous Shocks Facility and the catalytic effect it had on generating emergency financial assistance from other development partners, including the World Bank, the African Development Bank, the European Commission, and bilateral donors including Belgium.

Together, these helped reduce macroeconomic pressures going into the second half of the year.

The government's economic program for 2009–12 aims to address the challenges facing the country in line with our current Poverty Reduction and Growth Strategy, which we have extended through the end of 2010. Further, our second-generation strategy for 2011–15 is currently under preparation. Our program focuses on enhancing macroeconomic stability, increasing investment in physical and human capital formation, and the implementation of structural reforms to improve domestic resource mobilization, strengthen public financial management, enhance central bank independence, and boost our economy's productive capacity. These policies and reforms are set out in the attached Memorandum of Economic and Financial Policies (MEFP) for 2009–12 and accompanying Matrix of Structural Reforms. We also attach the Memorandum of Technical Understandings (TMU) that provides the modalities for monitoring program implementation.

I am pleased to inform you that we made significant progress in addressing earlier concerns over the debt sustainability implications of Sino-Congolese Cooperation Agreement involving large mining and infrastructure projects critical to our country's development. We agreed with our Chinese partners to remove the government guarantee on the financing of the mining component (US\$3.2 billion) and cancelled the second phase of infrastructure financing (US\$3 billion). This allowed us to limit the government guaranteed borrowing under the Agreement to strictly the US\$3 billion infrastructure component, which is highly concessional (i.e., grant element of 42–46 percent depending on whether the signing bonus is taken into account).

In this context, the Democratic Republic of the Congo is requesting IMF financial support under the Poverty Reduction and Growth Facility (PRGF) during the period July 2009–June 2012 in an amount of SDR 346.45 (or 65 percent) of quota. In addition, we request the resumption of interim relief under the enhanced HIPC initiative in the amount of SDR 45.66 million (20 percent of the total HIPC commitment) to help us cover part of the principal payments to the IMF falling due during the twelve month period from December 2009. IMF support will complement additional budget and balance of payments support being provided by other development partners, including the World Bank.

The government believes that the policies and reforms set forth in the attached MEFP are adequate to achieve our program's objectives. Nevertheless, we are committed to take any further measures that may prove necessary for achieving the program objectives. During the period covered by the three-year arrangement, the government will consult with the staff of the IMF on the adoption of any additional measures deemed to be appropriate.

The Government will provide the IMF with any information it may request for monitoring the implementation of the program's economic and financial policies. Furthermore, the government will conduct with the IMF a mid-term review of the first year of the program (July 2009–June 2010) no later than end-June 2010 and a

subsequent review of the annual program (January 2010–June 2010) no later than end-December 2010. The government intends to make the contents of this letter, the attached MEFP, the TMU, and the related IMF staff report available to the public. Therefore, it authorizes the Fund to publish these documents on its website once the Executive Board approves the PRGF arrangement and in the context of the subsequent reviews.

Sincerely yours,

_____/s/_____

Adolphe Muzito
Prime Minister

Attachments: Memorandum of Economic and Financial Policies
Technical Memorandum of Understanding

**APPENDIX I
ATTACHMENT I
TRANSLATED FROM FRENCH**

**DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC OF THE CONGO
MEMORANDUM OF ECONOMIC AND FINANCIAL POLICIES, 2009–12**

Kinshasa, November 30, 2009

I. INTRODUCTION

1. **This Memorandum describes the economic and financial policies as well as the structural reforms that the government intends to implement in its program supported by an arrangement under the Poverty Reduction and Growth Facility (PRGF) of the International Monetary Fund (IMF) for the period July 2009 to June 2012.** Through this program, the government is pursuing efforts to reestablish the conditions for lasting political, economic, and social stability. In particular, the proposed policies and reforms are aimed to address the legacy of decades of poor economic management, armed conflicts, corruption, and disregard for the rule of law.

2. **The government's three-year program supported by the PRGF arrangement is based on the Poverty Reduction and Growth Strategy (PRGS) paper drafted in 2006 in the context of a largely participatory approach supported by the democratically elected government.** The strategy is based on five pillars: (i) promote peace and good governance; (ii) consolidate macroeconomic stability and promote economic growth; (iii) improve access to social services; (iv) combat HIV/AIDS; and (v) promote proactive community involvement. Given that these objectives have yet to be realized, the government decided to extend its PRGS through December 2010, supported by a Priority Action Plan (PAP) which seeks to correct the weaknesses identified in the July 2008 PRGS progress report. The weaknesses included delays in implementing public financial management reforms, unexpected security-related spending, poor revenue mobilization, and weak institutional and human capacities. During this period, the government will prepare its second generation PRGS covering the period 2011–15 in a participatory manner.

II. OVERVIEW

3. **The government has made considerable progress on the social and political fronts.** Since 2003, the political transition has paved the way for democratization, restoration of peace, and reunification of the national territory with assistance from the international community, in particular through the deployment of a United Nations peacekeeping and institutional-building mission (MONUC).

4. **On the economic side, the government successfully implemented its interim economic program for the period June 2001 to March 2002** that was monitored by IMF staff (SMP), which ended a long period of hyperinflation and led to the Government's Economic Program (PEG) being supported by a PRGF arrangement in April 2002.

5. **At the same time, the government prepared its Interim Poverty Reduction and Growth Strategy paper (I-PRGS).** The priorities of the I-PRGS paper were restoration and reinforcement of peace, macroeconomic stabilization, and involvement of communities and civil society. The I-PRGS paper also identified ways in which new resources to finance the strategy could be generated. The satisfactory execution of the PEG underpinned by I-PRGS paper enabled the Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC) to reach Decision point under the Heavily Indebted Poor Countries (HIPC) Initiative in July 2003 and obtain interim debt relief. The implementation of the PRGF-supported program and interim debt relief allowed the Congolese economy, for the first time in a decade, to experience positive rates of growth and to reduce inflation to below 10 percent in 2003–04.

6. **The momentum of the reforms proved difficult to sustain on account of the continued conflict in the eastern provinces and the preparations for the first national election in 40 years.** As a result, the macroeconomic program went off track and certain performance criteria were not observed, resulting in the sixth and final PRGF review not being concluded prior to the expiration of the arrangement and the suspension of the program.

7. **Since 2006, the government has been implementing an IMF staff-monitored program that has been extended several times after yielding mixed results.** The escalation of the conflict in the eastern provinces made public financial management difficult and led to significant security-related expenditure overruns that were difficult to offset with other fiscal measures. In this context, the implementation of the PRGS was less satisfactory than foreseen.

8. **The DRC is facing major post-conflict challenges of reconstruction and rehabilitation of its dilapidated infrastructure, while maintaining macroeconomic stability and ensuring debt sustainability.** The continued presence and military activities of rebel forces have set back the implementation of the government's development agenda and put a strain on its limited budgetary resources. Economic recovery was hampered by nonexistent or dilapidated basic infrastructure (roads, railways, hospitals, and schools). These factors constrain productivity and increase the cost of doing business, thereby reducing competitiveness. The government therefore aims at achieving its dual objective of rebuilding the country's infrastructure and obtaining significant debt relief through the HIPC Initiative and the Multilateral Debt Relief Initiative (MDRI).

III. RECENT ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENTS (2008–09)

9. **The DRC was affected by the escalation of the conflict in the eastern provinces and the negative impact of exogenous shocks on the country's terms of trade following the onset of the global financial crisis.** On the domestic front, the search for a lasting solution to the security problems in the eastern region of the country resulted in the holding of a Conference on Peace, Security, and Development of the Great Lakes Region in January 2008. However, the conference failed to reduce tensions and conflict reemerged in October 2008, thus jeopardizing the progress made since the end of the political transition

and the establishment of the new democratic order. Through diplomatic efforts, the joint DRC-Rwanda and DRC-Uganda armed forces set out to dismantle the pockets of resistance created by Rwandan Hutu rebels (FDLR) and Ugandan rebels (LRA) in early 2009. These events resulted in significant unforeseen budgetary expenditures. Given the urgent and binding nature of these expenditures, the government at times had to execute them outside the expenditure chain. At the same time, the reduction in world demand and the sharp decline in export prices markedly reduced mining revenues. The combination of these endogenous and exogenous shocks widened the underlying fiscal deficit, increased net credit to government (NCG) from the banking sector, and reduced gross foreign reserves to less than one week of nonaid imports.

10. The global financial crisis weakened macroeconomic performance. In 2008, real GDP growth slowed to 6.2 percent (as opposed to a projected 10 percent) owing to the slump in mining sector activity. Inflation, which was at 27.6 percent at end-2008, peaked at over 55 percent in the first quarter of 2009, subsided in May and June, but started to rise in July and reached 54 percent in September in response to periodic strong increases in base money. At the same time, the Congolese franc depreciated from about CF 555 per U.S. dollar in September 2008 to about CF 880 per U.S. dollar at end October 2009.

11. The government implemented a stabilization program during the first half of 2009. It reduced borrowing from the central bank notwithstanding weak revenue performance. This, combined with a tight monetary policy, helped reduce inflation and stabilize the exchange rate. Despite these efforts, the impact of the global financial crisis, the continuation of conflict in the eastern provinces, and the need for the central bank to address liquidity problems regarding certain commercial banks resulted in deviations from the targets under our SMP.

12. Government implemented its economic program satisfactorily through the third quarter of 2009, but expenditure pressures have increased in the fourth quarter. All prior actions and quantitative benchmarks through September were observed. However, there was a large build-up of expenditure commitments in September and October reflecting unavoidable security-related spending and cost overruns on the Southern African Development Community (SADC) and Economic Community of Central African States (CEEAC) regional conference hosted by the DRC. The government has already initiated measures to ensure that program's fiscal objectives are met.

13. The government made progress in resolving the earlier cases of misreporting to the IMF. Up to end April 2008, a large number of government accounts held at the BCC and the commercial banks limited the transparency of government operations. Furthermore, the government did not always observe proper procedures regarding the payment by the central bank of urgent government spending, which led the misreporting of data to IMF staff. From May 2008, to remedy this problem, the government ordered an audit of all its accounts, including those related to urgent spending. Moreover, in May 2008 it implemented new procedures to improve the management and transparency of urgent spending. However, delays were experienced in implementing these procedures. To further strengthen urgent

spending management, the government adopted an inter-ministerial decree on December 29, 2008, that defined the scope for using urgent spending procedures. To date, the government successfully and transparently applied the new procedures and all payments on urgent government spending were in accordance with the December 2008 decree.

14. Following the international financial crisis, the government requested the IMF and other development partners to provide urgent balance of payments and budget support. In response, the IMF granted approximately US\$200 million through the Rapid Access Component of its Exogenous Shocks Facility. The World Bank granted US\$100 million, disbursed in multiple tranches starting in March 2009, while the African Development Bank (AfDB) disbursed about US\$97 million. Thanks to this support, international reserves rose to US\$250 million at end-July 2009. Other foreign partners, including the European Commission and Belgium, are providing emergency assistance to the DRC.

15. In order to rebuild the country's economic and social infrastructure, the government signed a cooperation agreement with a consortium of Chinese enterprises, which was amended in October 2009 to be consistent with debt sustainability. The agreement includes a government guarantee on US\$3 billion of financing for infrastructure development. The repayment of debt service associated with the financing will be covered by the profits of a joint venture between GECAMINES (a Congolese state-owned company) and the Chinese enterprises, and the government guarantee could only be invoked in the event that the joint venture fails to repay the entire debt service 25 years after its legal incorporation (i.e., 2034). In this context, the government believes that the deal is consistent with debt sustainability and the level of concessionality expected under a PRGF-supported program.

IV. MEDIUM-TERM ECONOMIC AND FINANCIAL POLICIES

16. The government is implementing its medium-term economic and financial policies for the period July 2009 to June 2012 against the backdrop of an improved security outlook in the eastern provinces. Relations with neighboring countries are being normalized. Nonetheless, the presence of foreign-armed groups, which continue to terrorize local populations, and the integration of former rebel elements into the army, continue to impose large security-related budget and humanitarian costs.

A. Macroeconomic framework

17. The macroeconomic objectives are as follows: (i) achieving an average growth rate of 6.5 percent in 2009–12, sustained by a recovery of mining sector activity and infrastructure projects; (ii) reducing end-period inflation to 9 percent by 2012 supported by the implementation of prudent monetary and fiscal policies; and (iii) maintain gross foreign reserves to the equivalent of about 10 weeks of nonaid imports by the end of the program period. The external current account deficit (excluding grants) is projected to increase over the medium term to an average of 34 percent of GDP, owing mainly to a sharp increase in investment related imports. Exports will gradually recover from the adverse effects of the global financial crisis as world demand improves. The external current deficit will be financed by foreign direct investment and development assistance, including debt relief.

B. Fiscal policy

18. Medium-term fiscal policy is geared to avoiding government recourse to central bank financing. The domestic fiscal deficit (cash basis) is targeted to decline from 3.3 percent of GDP in 2009 to 0.4 percent of GDP in 2012.⁹ Domestic revenue (excluding the signing bonus under the Sino-Congolese Cooperation Agreement) is projected to increase from about 15.7 percent of GDP in 2009 and to 20 percent of GDP in 2012, while domestically financed expenditure (including exceptional spending) will increase from 17.5 percent of GDP in 2009 to about 20 percent of GDP in 2012.

19. The government is committed to implement a prudent expenditure policy. Regarding current spending, the policy of standardizing public sector wages of central government and provinces in 2010 will be maintained, with a wage bill capped at 6.7 percent of GDP over the medium term. This objective will be achieved by improving the reliability of the computerized payroll procedure and the rationalization of civil service staffing. The program will provide realistic allocations for spending on goods and services taking into account the significant increase in public investment. Over the medium term, domestically financed investment will increase from about 2.9 percent of GDP to about 5 percent of GDP. Foreign-financed investment will rise from about 6 percent of GDP in 2009 to about 12 percent in 2012, reflecting large investments in infrastructure, including those under the Sino-Congolese Cooperation Agreement.

20. Moreover, the government is committed to creating the fiscal space needed to meet its development and poverty reduction objectives. In particular, a large share of domestic revenue (40 percent) will be transferred to provinces, which will be responsible for the implementation of the education, health, and rural sector development. These large transfers will help strengthen human capital formation especially for vulnerable groups and the poor in line with our growth and poverty reduction strategy. Further, the country expects to reach the completion point under the HIPC Initiative in 2010 in order to benefit from debt relief associated with that initiative and debt cancellation under the MDRI. The government commits to conducting a prudent external debt management policy, including by relying on grants and highly concessional loans with a grant element significantly exceeding 35 percent for development financing. More importantly, the government will refrain from contracting or guaranteeing new debt that would jeopardize debt sustainability. It also intends to request from Paris Club creditors the extension over the medium term of the Cologne terms rescheduling agreement reached in 2002, the rescheduling of arrears accumulated since July 2006, and an exceptional rescheduling of debt service falling due in September-December 2009. It is also planned to normalize relations with non-Paris Club bilateral and commercial creditors. In turn, it will avoid accumulating any new arrears on nonreschedulable external debt during the program period. The government will also seek to reach rescheduling agreements on similar terms with non-Paris Club creditors.

⁹ Domestic fiscal balance is defined as total revenue (excluding grants and proceeds from signing bonus from the SCCA) minus total expenditure (excluding foreign financed projects and foreign interest payments due) plus the BCC's net operating deficit and net accumulation of domestic arrears).

C. Monetary and exchange policies

21. **The objective of monetary policy is price stability under a floating exchange rate regime.** The BCC will strengthen the monetary policy framework by making its indirect monetary policy instruments more flexible, and enhancing its liquidity management and forecasting capacity. In the interest of transparency, it will adopt a communication strategy to signal its policies to markets. In addition, the BCC will apply an exchange rate policy aimed at smoothing exchange rate fluctuations. With a view to improving financial intermediation, boost confidence in credit institutions, and encourage de-dollarization, the BCC will also improve the quality of currency in circulation, strengthen banking supervision, and develop a payments and settlements system.

D. Structural policies

22. Structural reforms are focused on increasing domestic revenue, strengthening public financial management, restructuring and recapitalizing the BCC, strengthening monetary policy and banking supervision, and putting the economy on strong and lasting growth path. The detailed measures and timetable are provided in the attached Matrix of Economic and Financial Policy Measures.

Revenue and expenditure policy

23. **Tax policy (*Matrix, I.A.*):** The government has adopted an action plan aimed at enhancing the efficiency of revenue collection while expanding the tax base. The main step will be the introduction of a single rate value-added tax (VAT), to be implemented by end-2011. Other measures will be taken to rationalize tax exemptions and streamline the plethora of duties and taxes and their collection procedures. This effort will be complemented by the adoption of a new Customs Code in line with international best practices.

24. **Customs administration (*Matrix, I.B.*):** The government's is committed to put in place an efficient and modern customs administration. To this end, it will streamline customs procedures to reduce costs to the private sector while improving internal administration and controls to increase revenue collection. To simplify collection procedures, the government will expand one-stop customs windows to all important border posts, including in the eastern provinces. Moreover, it will transfer the customs activities currently performed by the Congolese Control Office (OCC) to the Custom and Excise Collection Agency (OFIDA), thereby making it the sole agency in charge of customs valuation and the collection of all taxes and fees. OCC's role will henceforth be limited to quality and standards control. OFIDA will enhance its information technology systems, based on SYDONIA++, in all customs offices. To improve oversight and ensure the satisfactory implementation of reforms, OFIDA will be converted into a general directorate of the Ministry of Finance.

25. **Tax administration (*Matrix, I.C.*):** The government will also establish an efficient and a modern tax administration. It will expand the network of corporate tax centers (CDIs) to manage the taxation of corporations at the national level, and establish tax centers (CIS)

focused on middle and small enterprises. The development of a comprehensive taxpayer databank, combined with the adoption of a single identification numbers for all business entities, will improve post- and pre-collection controls and expand the tax base. The government will also strengthen post-collection controls by consolidating the audit and research functions of the tax department into a single office while improving its information system.

26. Collection of mining sector taxes (*Matrix, I.D.*): The government's objective is to increase the contribution of the mining sector to domestic revenue, which has been weak thus far. Accordingly, the government will strengthen the capacity of the tax department's (DGI) Large Taxpayers Office responsible for revenue collection from the sector, including by cooperating closely with specialized audit companies. Further, the collection of royalties and mining taxes (outside customs) will be transferred from the Directorate of Administrative and State Revenue (DGRAD) to the DGI, with the relevant legislation planned to be submitted to Parliament by April 2010. OFIDA will also establish specialized centers to assess adequately the quality and values of key mineral exports.

27. Public financial management (*Matrix, I.E.*): The government recognizes the need to improve public financial management to ensure the efficiency of budget preparation and implementation. It will implement over the program period an action plan built on the following five strategic pillars: (i) modernization of the legal framework, including the adoption of organic law on public finance and of a procurement code; (ii) improvement of the annual process of budget preparation, based on a medium-term fiscal framework that will be initially applied to key sector such as health and education; (iii) streamlining budget execution and cash management to improve the expenditure tracking process in order to avoid the accumulation of arrears; (iv) strengthening the reporting of expenditure execution through progressive computerization; and (v) reinforcing ex-ante and ex-post budget controls, including by the adoption of organic law on the audit office.

28. The Government intends to normalize its relationship with all its creditors. The government intends to start negotiate with all its creditors, in particular Paris Club creditors to obtain debt rescheduling in the most favorable terms given the weak repayment capacity of the country. Regarding the London Club, the government intends to finalize discussions for the cancellation of the commercial debt in the context of a buy-back program supported by the World Bank. It will seek to obtain from non-Paris Club creditors debt relief in terms that are at least comparable to those obtained from the Paris Club.

29. The authorities are putting in place a comprehensive program to address the stock of arrears and other claims on the government. An action plan for the gradual repayment of the stock of arrears at end-2007 has been put in place. In particular, fifty percent of the stock of arrears at end-2007 will be cleared in 2010 and the balance in 2011. A repayment plan for the stock of 2008 arrears based the internal audit of the *Inspection General des Finances* will be designed no later than February 2010. In addition, the government will establish a plan to compile an inventory of all remaining claims on the government with proper auditing procedures.

Financial sector

30. **Central bank restructuring and recapitalization (*Matrix, II.A.*):** The objective is to enhance the BCC's operational capacity while putting it on a sound financial footing. Accordingly, the first step will be to restructure the BCC in line with the action plan developed with IMF technical assistance. Following the recent nominations of Director General and Directors, the BCC will put in motion the reorganization of departments and units within the central bank. It has adopted a three-year strategic plan that aims to improve governance and reinforce the bank's capacity to execute effectively its responsibilities. In parallel, the government will put in motion the process for recapitalizing the central bank, which is expected to take place in 2011.

31. **Banking supervision (*Matrix, II.C.*):** The government's objective is to strengthen banking supervision with a view of safeguarding financial system stability and soundness. Reforms in this area include improving the legal and regulatory framework, enhancing the operating skills of bank inspectors, introducing macro-prudential functions, and strengthening on-site and off-site inspection. Particular emphasis will be placed on increasing the minimum capital requirements for banks, adopting more stringent licensing procedures, and improving the quality and professionalism of inspectors.

Other structural reforms

32. **Civil service reform (*Matrix, III.A.*):** The improvement of administrative governance through capacity building is critical to national reconstruction. In August 2009, the government intends to approve a medium-term retirement strategy for public sector employees and to submit a draft civil service law to parliament in December 2009, including a regime governing provincial-level civil servants. The civil service census will be completed in December 2009 and that for the army and police will be completed by December 2010.

33. **Business climate (*Matrix, III.B.*):** An improved business climate is at the core of the government's strategy to revitalize the private sector. The government is determined to strengthen the protection of investments by joining the Organization for the Harmonization of Business Law in Africa (OHADA). It will also convert the National Investment Promotion Agency (ANAPI) into a one-stop shop for investment in the DRC. Planned changes in laws and regulations will help reduce red tape in establishing companies and settling commercial disputes. The government will continue to set up commercial and labor courts in the remaining provinces and adopt a commercial code aimed at eliminating tariff and non-tariff barriers, in compliance with the international agreements ratified by the DRC.

34. **Decentralization (*Matrix, III.C.*):** The government is placing particular emphasis on fiscal decentralization consistent with the 2006 Constitution. The Constitution establishes the principle of revenue sharing between the central government and the provinces. The goal is to improve the quality of public services at the local level. However, the decentralization process also poses certain risks, and the government has taken transitional measures to improve PFM at the provincial level in anticipation of the approval of the organic law on

public finance. It will improve the mechanism for allocating national revenue to the provinces and decentralized territorial entities (ETDs) and to draft laws on the exclusive functions and powers of the provinces in order to guarantee effective public spending.

35. **Debt management (*Matrix, III.D.*)**: The government will strengthen external and domestic debt management in order to limit risks of debt sustainability. To this end, the government acknowledges the exclusive authority of the Minister of Finance to make commitments on the government's behalf regarding borrowing by the central, provincial, and local authorities. External and domestic debt management will be centralized in the Public Debt Management Office (OGEDEP), which will produce a biannual statistical bulletin and quarterly forecasts of public debt service.

36. **Economic governance (*Matrix, III.E. & F.*)**: Transparency and improvement of economic governance are important elements of our strategy to encourage private investment. The government undertakes to publish, within 60 days, the partnership contracts between public and private enterprises, including the relevant financial and tax details. It will set up an independent anti-corruption agency. The government also intends to improve the national statistics in order to enhance the reliability of macroeconomic, social, and demographic data. Finally, the government will implement the action plan for the Extractives Industries Transparency Initiative (EITI) to bolster the transparency of the mining industries and their impact on tax revenue.

37. **Public enterprises (*Matrix, III.G.*)**: **The government intends to accelerate public enterprise reform to improve the delivery of services critical for promoting economic growth.** It plans to divest from all enterprises involved in commercial activities. The process is ongoing and is implemented in two steps. In the first step, the government has initiated the privatization of the management of public enterprises, which is aimed at stabilizing and improving their financial situation. In the second step, the government will develop restructuring and privatization plan. To facilitate the public enterprise restructuring and privatization process, the government will develop social programs to help redundant public enterprise employees eligible to retirement or departing on a voluntary basis and a plan to address cross-debts between public enterprises and between public enterprises and the government. Enterprises that are involved in nonprofit activities or that are extensions of government agencies will be transformed, as appropriate, into public establishments while those whose activities have ceased or are no longer warranted will be dissolved.

V. POLICY FOR THE REST OF 2009 AND FOR 2010

38. **The macroeconomic objectives for 2009 are:** (i) a real GDP growth rate of 2.7 percent sustained by the partial revitalization of the mining and construction sectors and by the expansion of the agriculture, telecommunications, and transport sectors; (ii) limiting year-on-year inflation at 48.7 percent; and (iii) maintain the coverage of gross foreign reserves at about 10 weeks of nonaid imports. To attain these objectives, prudent macroeconomic policies will need to be put in place, as well as structural and sectoral reforms to promote a business climate conducive to the development of a viable private sector that would underpin strong and lasting economic growth.

39. **The objective of fiscal policy for the rest of 2009 is to limit the government's recourse to domestic financing.** In this regard, the domestic fiscal deficit (cash basis) will be limited to 3.3 percent of GDP, consistent with a reduction of net credit to the government of 1.2 percent of GDP. Tax revenue for the year as a whole is estimated at 15.6 percent of GDP and domestically financed expenditure will be capped at 17.5 percent of GDP. Foreign-financed investment is projected to reach 6.2 percent of GDP, including infrastructure projects implemented under the Sino-Congolese Cooperation Agreement.

40. **The excessive level of expenditure commitments in the pipeline at end-October (CF 258 billion) requires corrective measures to ensure consistency with the treasury plan 2009.** Given the level of commitments at end-October, certain sectoral ministries and other institutions have very little room to maneuver. To address the situation, the government has (i) cancelled all commitments for which goods and services have not been committed (CF 68 billion); (ii) postponed the repayment of part of the arrears accumulated in 2007–08 (CF 31 billion), pending their audit; and (iii) stopped all new commitments at end-October. These measures should allow achieve fiscal policy objectives.

41. **The objective of monetary policy in 2009 is to contain inflation in the context of a floating exchange rate regime.** The expansion of the monetary base will be limited to 19.6 percent in 2009. Broad money is projected to grow at 33.8 percent. To achieve the monetary targets, the BCC will continue to sell BTRs (central bank bills) to mop up excess liquidity in the economy. Its plan for selling BTRs will be drawn up in close collaboration with the Treasury. Exchange rate intervention will aim at smoothing undue volatility while achieving the reserve target. Subject to the reserve target, the central bank also could sell foreign exchange to help mop up excess liquidity, especially that generated by government use of external budget support.

42. **Key structural reforms for the period July 2009 to June 2010** include the promulgation of a new organic public finance law, adoption of a world class procurement code, streamlining of duties and taxes, evaluation and elimination of ad hoc tax exemptions, the transfer of OFIDA into a department of the Ministry of Finance, the restructuring of the BCC and the modernization of its monetary policy instruments, and the submission to Parliament of a new statistics law.

43. **The objective of fiscal policy for 2010 will be to limit recourse to domestic financing.** In this context, the domestic fiscal deficit (cash basis) will be limited to 1.4 percent of GDP, consistent with zero net credit to the government from the banking system. Tax revenue and domestically financed expenditure are both projected to be 17.9 percent of GDP and 18.8 respectively. Foreign-financed capital expenditure is projected at 14 percent of GDP.

44. **The main objective of monetary policy in 2010 will be to further reduce inflation.** In that context, the growth of base money is targeted at 22 percent in 2010. With money multiplier expected to remain stable, broad money growth is also projected to grow in line with base money. The BCC will review its policy rate taking into account progress toward the inflation objectives.

VI. TECHNICAL ASSISTANCE NEEDS AND PRIORITIES FOR TRAINING

45. **The government will request technical assistance from the international community in macroeconomic and structural reforms.** It is grateful for the technical assistance provided by the IMF through its Central African Regional Technical Assistance Centers (Central AFRITAC), the World Bank, the AfDB, the UNDP, and other development partners. This technical assistance will be a determining factor in the success of the decentralization process and in the formulation and implementation of sectoral policies as defined in our PRGS. The government will prepare a list of technical assistance needs and priorities for strengthening institutional capacity at the provincial level.

VII. PROGRAM MONITORING

46. **The monitoring of program will be carried out on the basis of quantitative performance criteria and benchmarks as well as structural benchmarks in the context of semi-annual reviews** (Tables 1–2). The first review will be completed by end-June 2010 and will cover macroeconomic developments and policies for 2010 and progress in structural reforms in tax and customs administration, PFM, and financial sector reform. An update safeguards assessment is currently in progress in the context of the proposed PRGF arrangement, as required by the IMF safeguards policy.

47. **In the context of the proposed PRGF, an update safeguards assessment of the Banque Centrale du Congo (BCC) is currently in progress.** The previous update assessment, concluded in January 2008, found a strengthened external audit mechanism, but significant safeguards risks remained in the control framework of the central bank, including serious concerns regarding the bank's independence. As a result, the assessment recommended specific measures for implementation in advance of a Board discussion of a new PRGF arrangement. The BCC agreed with the findings of the assessment and committed to implementing the safeguards recommendations, some of which were prior actions and others are structural benchmarks in the proposed PRGF program. Staff is monitoring BCC's implementation of the measures. The update assessment will be completed no later than the first review.

48. **The government is strengthening its program monitoring and evaluation capacity.** A National Steering Committee on the Poverty Reduction Strategy (CNP–SRP) will be established directly under the authority of the Prime Minister. This Committee will be assisted by the Interministerial Technical Committee in the Prime Minister's Office and will supervise the activities of the two interministerial committees: one in charge of drafting the National Poverty Reduction Strategy (CI-SNLCP) and the other in charge of steering and monitoring the implementation of the PRS (CISPI). The CI-SNLCP will be chaired by the Minister of Planning, assisted by the other members, namely the ministers in charge of priority sectors. Its mission will be to steer the process of preparing the national poverty reduction strategy. As part of its mission, it will work closely with the Steering Committee for the Poverty Reduction Strategy Preparation Process (UPPE-SRP). The CISPI will be chaired by the Minister of Finance and its members will include the ministers of Budget,

Economy, Planning, Trade, and those ministers concerned with the implementation of the reforms. It will be assisted by the technical committee for monitoring reforms (CTR). The government has also established an Interministerial Technical Committee (CTSP) that monitors the implementation of the government's macroeconomic program supported by the PRGF arrangement.

Table I.1. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Quarterly Quantitative Performance Criteria and Indicative Targets, 2009–10¹
(CGF Millions, unless otherwise indicated)

	2008	2009 Cumulative change ²						2009	2010 Cumulative change ³				2010
	Stock Dec.	Sept.	Indic. Targets Adj.	Act.	Difference	Observation Prel.	Dec.	Stock Dec.	March	June	Sept.	Dec.	Stock Dec.
	Prel	Indic. Targets					Perf. Criteria	Proj.	Bench.	Perf. Criteria ⁴	Bench.	Bench.	Proj.
I. Performance criteria													
a. Floor on net foreign assets of the BCC ⁵ (U.S.\$ millions)	-610	23	-103	-97	6	Observed	35	-576	0	451	516	497	-79
b. Ceiling on net domestic assets of the BCC ⁵	773,772	6,246	107,277	83,691	-23,587	Observed	51,343	825,115	4,307	-260,923	-286,205	-217,169	607,946
c. Ceiling on net bank credit to government	260,560	-138,817	-37,786	-49,948	-12,162	Observed	-105,837	154,723	-34,776	-23,242	15,920	0	154,723
d. Ceiling on the contracting or guaranteeing of new nonconcessional external debt with original maturity of more than one year by the government, including local governments or the BCC ⁶	...	0	...	...	...	...	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
e. Ceiling on the contracting or guaranteeing of new nonconcessional external debt with original maturity of less than one year by the government, including local governments or the BCC ⁶	...	0	...	...	...	...	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
f. BCC payments of government expenditure (including urgent in nature) without authorization according to proper budgetary procedures by the ministries of finance and budget ⁶	...	0	...	...	...	...	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
g. Accumulation of External payments arrears ⁶	...	0	...	...	...	...	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
II. Indicative targets													
a. Narrow base money	378,098	21,076	21,076	21,880	804	Not Observed	75,016	453,114	4,448	27,717	44,130	101,005	554,119
b. Domestic balance (cumulative from the beginning of the year)		-187,501	...	-181,558	5,943	Observed	-285,251	...	55,623	79,117	-57,794	-153,960	...
c. Accumulation of wage arrears		0		0			0		0	0	0	0	
Memorandum items: Project deposits	11,661	0	0	0	0		0	11,661	0	0	0	0	11,661

Source: Congolese authorities; and IMF staff estimates and projections.

¹ For definition and adjustors see the attached Program Monitoring Section of Memorandum of Economic and Financial Policies and the Technical Memorandum of Understanding.

² Cumulative changes are calculated from end-December 2008.

³ Cumulative changes are calculated from end-December 2009.

⁴ These performance criteria may be revised in the context of the first review of the PRGF arrangement.

⁵ The stocks of net foreign assets and net domestic assets of the BCC are valued at the program exchange rates (US\$1 = CGF 639.32; and 1 Euro = 905.07).

⁶ These performance criteria will be monitored on a continuous basis.

Table I.2. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Structural Conditionality and Macroeconomic Relevance, 2009–10

Measure	Status	Macroeconomic Rationale
Prior Actions		
Establishment of a committee to assess tax incentives and exemptions granted under the mining code, investment code, and special conventions in accordance with terms of reference devised in consultation with IMF staff.	Observed	Enhance revenue mobilization to achieve the fiscal objectives of the program
Collection of all revenue from the mining sector by a new unit specialized in mining taxation along with the Large Taxpayers Unit.	Observed	Enhance revenue mobilization to achieve the fiscal objectives of the program.
Finalization of the audit of domestic arrears accumulated as of end-December 2007 and adoption by government of a plan of eliminating them.	Observed	To ensure meeting the obligations of the government to the private sector and avoid stunting private sector development and economic growth.
Operational implementation of the National Financial Intelligence Unit (CENAREF) in the context of anti-money laundering efforts.	Observed	Promote orderly financial sector development
Amend the Sino-Congolese cooperation agreement to ensure that its terms are consistent with debt sustainability.	Observed	Strengthen debt management to achieve debt sustainability.
Selection of an audit firm of international repute to audit the PRGF criteria for the duration of the program (2009–11)	Observed	Reinforce program monitoring and control.
Appointment of directors at the BCC, to be in charge of the new Directorate created in the context of the central bank restructuring	Observed	Promote the modernization of the BCC , in particular in improve its monetary policy design and banking supervision
Structural benchmarks		
Restructuring one large commercial bank.	End-Dec. 2009	Systemic risk.
Adoption by the Council of Ministers of an action plan prepared by the committee responsible for assessing tax incentives and exemptions granted under the mining code, investment code, and special convention.	End- Dec. 2009	Enhance revenue mobilization to achieve the fiscal objectives of the program.
Implementation of ASYCUDA++ in the customs offices in Kinshasa	End- Dec. 2009	Enhance revenue mobilization to achieve the fiscal objectives of the program.
Repayment plan for 2008 arrears based the internal audit of the Inspection General des Finances and establish a plan to identify and audit of any remaining government arrears.	End- Feb. 2010	To ensure meeting the obligations of the government to the private sector and avoid stunting private sector development and economic growth.
Submission to Parliament of a draft organic law on public finance that <i>inter alia</i> prohibits provinces from borrowing from commercial banks and the Central Bank.	End-March. 2010	Establish fiscal discipline based on transparent rules and regulations
Generation and publishing of a monthly budget execution tables (reconciled with the TOFE, the BCC, and the monetary statistics), no later than 30 days after the end of each month.	Continuous	Strengthen the monitoring of the program
Inclusion of externally financed expenditure in the monthly budget execution tables (reconciled with the TOFE, the BCC, and the monetary statistics), no later than 3 months after the end of each month.	Continuous	Strengthen the monitoring of the program
Publication of mining sector partnership contracts between public and private enterprises with 60 days of signature (including urgent expenditure payments) without prior authorization by the Minister of Finance in accordance with existing legislation.	Continuous	Enhance economic governance and ensure accountability for public resources
No payment by the BCC of expenditures on behalf of the government (including urgent expenditure payments) without prior authorization by the Minister of Finance in accordance with existing legislation.	Continuous	Enhance economic governance and ensure accountability for public resources

Source: Congolese authorities; and IMF staff assessments

Table I.3. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Matrix of Economic and Financial Policy Measures for 2009–12

Area	Measures	Timing
I. Tax and fiscal policies and reforms		
A. Tax policy	Objective: Modernize the Tax System	
	1. Reduce the number of low-yielding taxes:	
	Adoption by the Council of Ministers the report on identifying low-yielding taxes.	End-December 2009
	Submit to Parliament draft laws on the elimination of these taxes.	End-June 2010
	2. Limit tax and customs incentives and exemptions:	
	Adoption by the Council of Ministers of the action plan prepared by the Commission in charge of evaluation of incentives and fiscal exemptions granted in the framework of the Mining Code, Investment Code, and special conventions. (Structural benchmark)	End-December 2009
	Refrain from granting or renewing discretionary tax incentives and exemptions outside the investment, mining, and forestry codes.	Ongoing
	3. Reduce the number of nuisance taxes and border fees:	
	Produce a report identifying parafiscal taxes and border fees, without a quid pro quo, and adopt an action plan to eliminate them	End-December 2009
	Implement this action plan.	End-December 2010
	4. Establish the VAT:	
	Adopt and enact the draft law establishing the modern single-rate VAT.	End-December 2010
	Collect the first VAT tax returns from businesses by the DGI.	End-January 2012
	5. Implement the new customs code:	
	Adoption by the Council of Ministers.	End-December 2009
	Submission to the Parliament.	End-December 2009
	Promulgation by the President.	End-June 2010
B. Customs administration	Objective: Modernize Customs Administration	
	1. Transfer customs activities from the Congolese Office of Control (OCC) to OFIDA:	
	Adoption by the Council of Ministers of the new statutes for OCC and OFIDA.	December 2009
	Approval by the Council of Ministers the action plan for the effective transfer of customs activities from the OCC to OFIDA.	April 2010
	2. Issuance by the Prime Minister of a decree to convert OFIDA into a Directorate-General of Customs reporting to the Ministry of Finance.	End-December 2009
	3. Strengthen the rules requiring pre-inspection of imports by BIVAC; for goods not yet subject to pre-inspection, OFIDA will determine their value by using the BIVAC database.	End-December 2009

Table I.3. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Matrix of Economic and Financial Policy Measures for 2009–12 (Continued)

Area	Measures	Timing
B. Customs administration (continued)	Objective: Modernize Customs Administration	
	4. Implement ASYCUDA++ in all customs offices where the volume and type of trade justify it: - At Kinshasa. (Structural benchmark) - At other customs office that account for either a minimum of 5 percent of imports (CIF value) or a minimum of 10 percent of transit (CIF value).	End-December 2009 End-December 2011
	5. Introduce the one-stop window at all customs offices.	End-December 2011
C. Tax administration	Objective: Strengthen Tax Administration	
	1. Merge the DGRAD with the DGI: - Set up an independent commission to study the advisability and feasibility of merging the DGRAD with the DGI. - Adoption by the Council of Ministers the report on the advisability and feasibility of merging the DGRAD with the DGI.	End-September 2009 End-March 2010
	2. Extend the use of the new single tax identification number (NIF) to all provinces.	End-June 2010
	3. Transfer all enterprises that meet the eligibility criteria to the DGE portfolio.	End-December 2009
	4. Establish tax centers (CDIs) in all provinces to manage medium-sized enterprises: - Establish three CDIs: Bas Congo, Nord Kivu and Sud Kivu. - Establish CDIs in all other provinces.	End-March 2010 End-December 2011
D. Tax collection in the mining sector	Objective: Increase Revenues from the Mining Sector	
	1. Sign a memorandum of understanding with other public institutions on the exchange of information on mining sector exports.	End-December 2009
	2. Strengthen tax administration in the mining sector: - Strengthen the capacity of the specialized unit, including by means of agreements with specialized audit companies and international consulting firms. - Submit to Parliament draft legislation to transfer all responsibility for tax administration in the mining sector from the DGRAD to the new specialized unit in the DGE, which becomes responsible for internal assessment, in line with international best practice, for the audit and collection of all taxes, fees, and royalties from the major mining companies.	End-December 2009 End-October 2010
	3. Starting in July 2009, conduct annual audits by the Inspectorate General of Finance, six months after the year in question, to verify that all tax revenue paid by the mining companies have been transferred to the general account of the Treasury.	Ongoing
	4. In the context of strengthening the capacity of OFIDA, establish centers of expertise for the principal mining exports at Kasumbalesa and Sakanina in Katanga.	End-June 2010

Table I.3. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Matrix of Economic and Financial Policy Measures for 2009–12 (Continued)

Area	Measures	Timing
E. Public finance management	Objective: Strengthen Public Finance Management	
	Adoption by the Government of a Public Financial Management Action Plan	End-March 2010
(i) Legal and institutional aspects	1. Submit to Parliament a draft organic law on public finance that specifically prohibits provinces from borrowing from commercial banks and the Central Bank. (Structural Benchmark)	End-March 2010
	2. Submit to Parliament the 2008 draft budget review law by the Audit Office.	End-December 2009
	3. Adopt the new Public Procurement Code and its implementing regulations.	End-December 2009
	4. Reform the financing of the tax collection agencies: - Eliminate the transfers to the three government tax collection agencies. - Replace performance premiums with operating and capital budget appropriations and by incentives for agents in the tax collection agencies.	End-July 2010 End-January 2011
	5. Approve general regulations on government accounting.	End-December 2010
	6. Submit to Parliament a draft organic law on the Audit Office.	End-December 2010
	7. Review the regulatory framework of the Inspectorate General of Finance.	End-December 2010
(ii) Preparation of the budget	1. Develop a medium-term budget framework: - For the ministries of health and education. - In all ministries, in close cooperation with the sector ministries.	End-March 2010 End-December 2012
(iii) Budget execution	1. Publish a decree by the Minister of Finance to oblige the government to pay resident suppliers in the DRC in local currency.	End-December 2009
	2. Conduct an audit of all accounts of government entities at the BCC and at commercial banks.	End-December 2009
	3. Strengthen the computerized expenditure process by improving the software and updating the hardware.	End-December 2010
	4. Regularization of arrears on domestic payments: - Prepare repayment plan for the stock of domestic payment arrears at end-2008 based on audit of the Inspection General des Finance. (Structural Benchmark) - Implement action plan for gradual repayment of stock of arrears at end-2008.	February 2010 2010–11
	5. Reduce the use of the exceptional expenditure procedure by: - Strictly adhere to the December 2008 Decree and stopping the use of “mise à dispositions”. - Prepare an exit strategy to integrate the urgent spending procedure into the computerized expenditure cycle	Ongoing End-December 2009
	6. Prepare a commitment plan that is consistent with the cash-flow plan.	Ongoing
(iv) Accounting system and budget reports	1. Finalize the implementation of double entry bookkeeping at the Directorate of the Treasury in the Ministry of Finance and expand it to all revenue collection agencies.	End-December 2009
	2. Production and publication of monthly tables: (Structural benchmark) - Generate and publish monthly budget execution tables (reconciled with the TOFE, the BCC, and the monetary statistics), no later than 30 days after the end of each month. - Include externally financed expenditures in the monthly budget execution tables ((reconciled with the TOFE, the BCC, and the monetary statistics), no later than 3 months after the end of each month.	Ongoing

Table I.3. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Matrix of Economic and Financial Policy Measures for 2009–12 (Continued)

Area	Measures	Timing
E. Public finance management (concluded)	Objective: Strengthen Public Finance Management	
(v) Payroll management	- Check consistency between human resource database and payroll management for Extend the Simplified Transitional System (PTS) for the payroll to: - All public officials and government employees. - All provinces. - Unify the various government employee management systems, particularly by revising the structure of schedules applicable to those systems.	End-March 2010 End-December 2010 End-December 2010
II. Monetary and Financial Policy		
A. BCC Reform	Objective: Make the Central Bank Independent and Efficient	
(i) <i>Restructuring of the BCC</i>	- Implement the new organization and restructuring of the BCC. - Establish organic units under every directorate in accordance with the organizational chart developed with the technical assistance of the IMF MCM department. - Approve the delegation of responsibilities to General Directors and Directors for all ordinary transactions of the central bank and all other administrative decisions developed with the technical assistance of the IMF MCM department.	End-September 2009 End-September 2009
(ii) <i>Recapitalization of the BCC</i>	- Adoption by the Council of Ministers of the action plan to recapitalize the BCC based on the recommendations of the IMF technical assistance mission. - Submit to the Parliament the draft law on the BCC recapitalization. - Adoption by the Council of Ministers of the budget required to recapitalize the central bank by issuing government securities , at interest rates and maturities to be determined in line with market conditions. - Recapitalize the BCC.	End-February 2010 End-October 2010 End-November 2009 End-June 2011
B. Monetary policy	Objective: Improve the BCC's Capacity to make Monetary and Exchange Policy	
(i) <i>Liquidity forecasting/money market interventions</i>	Publicize the instruction authorizing the trading of BTRs on a secondary market.	End-September 2009
(ii) <i>Currency issuance and quality of currency in circulation</i>	- Increase the banknote processing capacity to 100 percent by allocating the necessary resources to the Treasury Directorate: 40 percent by June 2010. 70 percent by end-December 2010. 100 percent by June 2011. - Adopt a 3-year strategy to reform the currency issuance function in the provinces, to improve the quality of currency in circulation, in coordination with assistance from the IMF expert. - Issuance of coins in 2010 in accordance with the strategy developed with the assistance of the IMF expert.	2009–11 End-October 2009 End-September 2010
(iii) <i>Exchange transactions</i>	Hold regular foreign exchange auctions and publish an advance notice on the Internet, to ensure a regular presence and transparency on the foreign exchange market.	Continuous

Table I.3. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Matrix of Economic and Financial Policy Measures for 2009–12 (Continued)

Area	Measures	Timing
C. Supervision/ Banking system	Objective: Enhance Banking Supervision Capacity and the Health of the Banking System	
(i) Supervision	1. Strengthen the central bank's supervision capacity by implementing new commercial bank prudential ratios.	End-October 2009
	2. Implement a new matrix of sanctions for noncompliance with the banking supervision regulations.	End-December 2009
(ii) Banking system	1. Complete the audits to assess the quality of the loan portfolio: - Of three banks, and establish a plan to restructure and/or recapitalize them, in coordination with their boards of directors. - Of all remaining banks, and establish a plan to restructure and/or recapitalize them.	End-December 2009 End-March 2010
	2. Adopt a strategy to strengthen the health of commercial banks based on the results of the March 2009 evaluation study undertaken with technical assistance from IMF and World Bank experts.	End-November 2009
	3. Restructuring one large commercial bank	End-December 2009
D. Accounting and transparency	Objective: Improve Accounting and Transparency	
(i) Accounting and audit operations	1. No payments on government expenditures (including urgent expenditure) by the BCC that have not been authorized in advance by the Minister of Finance, in accordance with existing legislation. (Structural benchmark)	Ongoing
	2. Approval by the BCC's board of directors an action plan to apply the international accounting standards (IFRS).	End-December 2009
(ii) Transparency and communication	1. Publish the financial statements and audit reports of the BCC, no later than 6 months after the end of the year, including the auditor's opinion.	Continuous
III. Other Structural Reforms		
A. Civil Service	1. Complete the survey of the Civil Service.	End-April 2010
	2. Complete the survey of the Army and Police.	End-December 2010
B. Business climate	1. Submit to Parliament the OHADA membership treaty.	End-September 2009
	2. Eliminate all tariff and nontariff barriers that are not consistent with the international agreements ratified by the DRC.	End-March 2010
	3. Submit to Parliament the draft law on liberalization of the insurance sector.	End-March 2010
	4. Set up commercial courts in: - Kisangani and Matadi. - The remaining provinces.	End-December 2010 End-December 2011
C. Decentralization		
Policy	1. Implement the 40-percent revenue transfers formula: - Transitional period. - Implementation.	2009 January 2010
Tax and fee classifications for provinces and ETDs	1. Submit to the Parliament a draft law on the classification of taxes and fees of the provinces and ETDs.	End-October 2010

Table I.3. Democratic Republic of the Congo: Matrix of Economic and Financial Policy Measures for 2009–12 (Concluded)

Area	Measures	Timing
C. Decentralization (concluded)		
<i>Strengthen PFM at the provincial level</i>	1. Simplify budget classification at the provincial level: - Revise the revenue and expenditure classifications. - Introduce a simplified classification within the framework of the 2012 Budget Law for the provinces.	End-September 2010 End-December 2011
	2. Develop and approve an action plan to strengthen public financial management (PFM) capacity at the provincial level.	End-September 2010
	3. Introduce a computerized expenditure process in all provinces and link it to the central government's expenditure process.	End-December 2010
D. Debt management	1. Execute the action plan for effective implementation of the decree that centralizes external debt management in the OGEDEP including all information concerning public debt as well as all application measures.	End-December 2009
	2. Effectively collect and centralize data on internal and external public debt in the OGEDEP.	End-December 2009
E. Transparency	1. Publication within 60 days: - Of partnership agreements between public and private enterprises (including information on bonus signing shares, taxation system, private shareholders, and members of the board of directors. (Structural benchmark)) - Of the negotiation results between mining companies and the government regarding the review of mining contracts.	Ongoing End-June 2010
	2. Implement the Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative.	End-March 2010
	3. Establish an independent anti-corruption agency.	End-June 2010
F. Statistics	1. Submit to Parliament by the government the draft statistics law.	End-December 2009
	2. Revision of national accounts statistics: - Finalize national accounts estimates (SNA93) for 2006–07. - Adoption by the government of national accounts in accordance with SNA93.	End-March 2010 End-June 2010
	3. Finalization and adoption by the government the national statistical development strategy (SNDS).	End-September 2010
G. Public enterprise reform	1. Develop and submit to the Council of Ministers the social programs for the target enterprises (ONATRA, RVA, SNCC, REGIDESO, and SNEL)	End-July 2010
	2. Evaluate cross-debts between the government and the public enterprises, and between public enterprises: - Recruit the Cabinet. - Adopt the action plan by the government.	End-March 2010 End-September 2010

**APPENDIX I
ATTACHMENT II
TRANSLATED FROM FRENCH**

**DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC OF THE CONGO
TECHNICAL MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING
ON PROGRAM IMPLEMENTATION**

Kinshasa, November 30, 2009

1. This memorandum defines the quantitative targets that will be used to assess the performance by the Democratic Republic of the Congo under the program supported by the Poverty Reduction and Growth Facility (PRGF). It also specifies the content and frequency of the data needed for program monitoring. Unless otherwise indicated, all the quantitative targets are measured in terms of cumulative changes since January 1, 2009. Variables denominated in U.S. dollars will be converted to Congo francs by using the program exchange rate of CF 639.32 per US\$. Variables denominated in currencies other than the U.S. dollar (excluding SDRs and euros) will first be converted to U.S. dollars at the end-period US\$/currency exchange rate. Variables denominated in SDR will be valued at the program exchange rate of CF 994.02 per SDR. Variables denominated in euros will be valued at the program exchange rate of CF 905.07 per Euro.
2. **Institutional coverage: The central government** comprises all units of government that exercise authority over the entire economic territory. However, unless otherwise indicated for the purposes of this memorandum, the central government does not include nonprofit organizations controlled and financed by the central government. The **banking system** is understood to mean the Central Bank of the Congo (BCC) as well as existing or newly licensed commercial banks.

I. QUANTITATIVE PERFORMANCE CRITERIA

3. Quantitative performance criteria were established for end-December 2009 and end-June 2010, and indicative targets were set for end-September 2009 and end-March 2010 with regard to the following variables:
 - Changes in the net foreign assets of the BCC;
 - Changes in the net domestic assets of the BCC;
 - Changes in net banking system credit to the government (central government);
 - Payments of government expenditures (including emergency expenditures) by the BCC without the prior authorization according to proper budgetary procedures by the Ministries of Budget and Finance;

- Nonconcessional medium- and long-term foreign loans contracted or guaranteed by the central government, local governments, or the BCC;
- Nonconcessional short-term foreign loans contracted or guaranteed by the State, local governments, or the BCC; and
- The accumulation of external payment arrears.

A. Floors on the net foreign assets (NFA) of the BCC

4. **Definition:** NFA are defined as the difference between the BCC gross international reserves and its total liabilities. **Gross foreign assets** are defined as the sum of the following items: (i) monetary gold holdings of the BCC; (ii) SDR holdings; (iii) convertible claims on nonresidents, such as foreign deposits and foreign securities. The following items are excluded from the definition of gross reserves: claims on residents in foreign exchange, nonconvertible currency holdings, and reserves that are encumbered or pledged in one form or another, including but not limited to reserve assets used as collateral or security for foreign third-party liabilities. **Foreign liabilities** are all BCC foreign exchange liabilities to nonresidents (including SDR allocations), including the IMF.

5. The following **adjustments** will be made to the NFA floors.

- **Balance of payments support (BPS):** NFA will be adjusted (i) upward by an amount equivalent to total BPS in excess of the programmed levels, (ii) in July-December 2009 downward by an amount equivalent to the **lesser** of total shortfalls of BPS (excluding that from the IMF) relative to programmed levels and US\$45 million; (iii) downward by an amount equivalent to any shortfall in debt relief under the MDRI from the IMF; and (iv) in January-December 2010 downward by an amount equivalent to the excess of external debt service payments relative to programmed amounts.
- **Signing bonus from the Sino-Congolese Cooperation Agreement (SCCA):** NFA will be adjusted (i) upward by an amount equivalent to total disbursement of signing bonus from SCCA in excess of the programmed levels; (ii) downward by an amount equivalent to total shortfalls in the disbursement of signing bonus from SCCA relative to programmed levels.
- **Privatization proceeds in convertible currencies (PPCC):** NFA will be adjusted (i) upward by an amount equivalent to total PPCC in excess of the programmed levels; and (ii) in July-December 2009 downward by an amount equivalent to the **lesser** of total shortfalls in PPCC relative to programmed levels and US\$45 million.

6. **Definition:** BPS includes (all grants and loans) minus (grants and loans for externally financed projects) plus (debt relief granted by the IMF under the Multilateral Debt Relief Initiative) minus (external debt service payments (see ¶ 7 below)). External financing for the National Disarmament, Demobilization, and Reintegration Program (DDR) falls under the heading of externally financed projects and is therefore not included in the definition of BPS.

7. **Definition:** scheduled external debt service payments (excluding those to the IMF) are defined as debt service due (principal and interest) minus debt relief (excluding debt relief offered by the IMF).

B. Ceilings on the net domestic assets (NDA) of the BCC

8. **Definition:** The NDA of the BCC are defined as base money (see paragraph 18 below) minus NFA. Based on this definition, the NDA of the BCC include: (i) net credit to the government (central government) (see paragraph 10 below); (ii) credit to the private sector; (iii) credit to parastatal enterprises; (iv) credit to commercial banks; and (v) other net assets.

9. The following **adjustments** will be made to the NDA ceilings.

- **BPS:** NDA will be adjusted (i) downward by an amount equivalent to total BPS in excess of the programmed level; (ii) in July-December 2009 upward by an amount equivalent to the **lesser** of total shortfalls of BPS (excluding that from the IMF) relative to programmed levels and CF 35,276 million; (iii) upward by an amount equivalent to any shortfall in debt relief under the MDRI from the IMF; and (iv) in January-December 2010 upward by an amount equivalent to the excess of external debt service payments relative to programmed amounts.
- **Signing bonus from the SCCA:** NDA will be adjusted (i) downward by an amount equivalent to total disbursement of signing bonus from SCCA in excess of the programmed levels; (ii) upward by an amount equivalent to total shortfalls in the disbursement of signing bonus from SCCA relative to programmed levels.
- **Privatization proceeds:** NDA will be adjusted (i) downward by the total amount of privatization proceeds (including PPCC) in excess of the programmed level; and (ii) in July-December 2009 upward by an amount equivalent to the lesser of total shortfalls in PPCC relative to programmed levels and CF 35,276 million.

C. Ceiling on net banking system credit to the government (NCG)

Definition: NCG is defined as the sum of net BCC and commercial bank claims on the central government, plus the BCC's net cash deficit. For purposes of program monitoring, government deposits related to externally financed projects are excluded from NCG. External

budget support (BPS excluding balance of payment support from the IMF) will be converted to domestic currency by using the market exchange rate prevailing at the time of the disbursement.

10. The following **adjustments** will be made to the NCG ceiling.

- **BPS:** NCG will be adjusted (i) downward by an amount equivalent to total BPS (excluding that from the IMF) in excess of the programmed level, and (ii) upward by an amount equivalent to the **lesser** of total shortfalls in BPS (excluding that from IMF) relative to programmed levels and CF 35,276 million; and (iii) in January-December 2010 upward by an amount equivalent to the excess of external debt service payments relative to programmed amounts.
- **Signing bonus from the SCCA:** NCG will be adjusted (i) downward by an amount equivalent to total disbursement of signing bonus from SCCA in excess of the programmed levels; (ii) upward by an amount equivalent to total shortfalls relative to programmed levels in the disbursement of signing bonus from SCCA.
- **Privatization proceeds:** the NCG ceiling will be adjusted (i) downward by an amount equivalent to total privatization proceeds in excess of the programmed levels, and (ii) in July-December 2009 upward by an amount equivalent to the **lesser** of total shortfalls in privatization proceeds relative to programmed levels and CF 35,276 million.

D. Ceilings on new nonconcessional loans contracted or guaranteed by the central government, local governments, or the BCC

11. **Definition:** With regard to contracted or guaranteed debt, the central government is defined as all units of government that exercise authority over the entire economic territory, including nonprofit organizations controlled and financed by the central government.

12. **Definition:** Debt is defined in point 9 of the Guidelines on Performance Criteria with Respect to Foreign Debt in IMF arrangements (Decision No. 12274-00/85 of August 24, 2000; see Annex).

Ceilings on new medium- and long-term nonconcessional loans contracted or guaranteed by the central government, local governments, or the BCC

13. **Definition:** nonconcessional debt is defined as all loans with a grant element of less than 35 percent, calculated as the difference between the present value (PV) of the debt and its nominal value, expressed as a percentage of the nominal value of the debt. The PV of the debt at the time it is contracted is calculated by discounting future flows of payable debt service. The discount rates used for that purpose are the commercial interest reference rates (CIRR) specific to each currency, published by the OECD. The average ten-year CIRRs will

be used to calculate the PV of debt having a maturity of at least 15 years, and six-month average CIRRs for loans with shorter maturity. For the purposes of the program, the most recent CIRRs published by the OECD will be used to assess concessionality of loans.

14. **Definition:** the limit on nonconcessional medium- and long-term loans applies to contracted or guaranteed debt and liabilities for which the equivalent value has not been received. It excludes the use of IMF resources and debt contracted within the framework of a rescheduling or restructuring.

Ceilings on new nonconcessional short-term loans contracted or guaranteed by the central government, local governments, or the BCC

15. **Definition:** short-term debt is defined as debt having an initial maturity of one year or less, with the exception of regular import credits having a maturity of up to one year.

E. Ceiling on the accumulation of external payment arrears

16. **Definition:** external payment arrears include external debt service obligations (principal and interest) that were not paid on the contractual due date. The ceiling on new external payment arrears applies **continuously** throughout the period covered by the PRGF arrangement. It does not apply to external payment arrears in process of renegotiation or to cases in which the creditor has agreed to the suspension of payments pending the outcome of negotiations.

II. QUANTITATIVE INDICATIVE TARGETS

17. The indicative targets pertain to: (i) base money; (ii) the non-accumulation of wage arrears; and (iii) the domestic fiscal balance.

A. Ceilings on base money

18. **Definition:** base money is defined as the sum of (i) currency outside banks; (ii) cash holdings of commercial banks; (iii) deposits of commercial banks with the BCC; (iv) private sector deposits with the BCC; (v) deposits of parastatal enterprises with the BCC; and (vi) foreign exchange deposits and provisions for imports with the BCC.

B. Ceilings on the accumulation of wage arrears

19. **Definitions:** Wage arrears are defined as approved personnel expenses which have not been paid for 30 days. Wages include the total compensation paid employees (civil service; including permanent benefits). These arrears will be valued on a cumulative basis from January 1, 2009.

C. Ceiling on the domestic fiscal balance

20. **Definitions:** the **domestic fiscal balance** is defined as (domestic revenue) minus (domestically financed expenditure). **Domestic revenue** is defined as (total revenue and grants) minus (grants) minus (signing bonus from the SCCA). **Domestically financed expenditure** is defined as (total expenditure and net loans) minus (externally financed investments) minus (foreign interest payments) plus (the BCC's operating deficit) plus (the net accumulation of domestic arrears).

21. The following **adjustments** will apply to the ceiling on the domestic fiscal balance:

- **BPS:** In July-December 2009, the floors on the domestic fiscal balance will be adjusted upward by an amount equivalent to the excess of total shortfall of BPS (excluding that from the IMF) relative to programmed levels over CF 35,276 million.
- **Privatization proceeds:** In July-December 2009, the floors on domestic fiscal balance will be adjusted upward by an amount equivalent to the excess of total shortfall of privatization proceeds relative to programmed levels over CF 35,276 million.

III. CONSULTATION CLAUSE

22. In the event that revenue exceeds the programmed amounts during the program period, the authorities will consult the IMF before allocating any surplus revenue to additional expenditure. Further, the authorities will consult with the IMF before implementing any revisions to the policies contained in the MEFP.

IV. DATA TO BE REPORTED FOR PROGRAM MONITORING PURPOSES

23. The authorities of the DRC will provide IMF staff with the data needed to monitor the program within the prescribed time limits, as indicated in the following table.

Summary of Data to be Reported

Information	Responsible entity	Frequency	Reporting deadline
Volume of foreign exchange purchases and sales on the interbank market	BCC	Daily	One day
Volume of BCC purchases and sales on the interbank market	BCC	Daily	One day
Average CGF/USD reference exchange rate on the interbank market	BCC	Daily	One day
Average CGF/USD reference exchange rate	BCC	Daily	One day
Average CGF/USD reference exchange rate offered by commercial banks to their customers	BCC	Daily	One day
Average CGF/USD reference exchange rate used by exchange bureaus	BCC	Daily	One day
Integrated monetary survey	BCC	Monthly	2 weeks
BCC balance sheet	BCC	Monthly	One week
Monetary survey of retail banks	BCC	Monthly	2 weeks
Structure of retail banks' interest rates	BCC	Monthly	2 weeks
Reserves (voluntary and required) of retail banks	BCC	Daily	One day
Volume of CGF transactions on the interbank market	BCC	Daily	One day
Outstanding central bank claims on retail banks	BCC	Daily	One day
Foreign exchange sales (including through auctions) by the BCC	BCC	Weekly	One week
Outstanding and new issues of central bank bills (BTR)	BCC	Weekly	One day
Change in the free reserves of banks	BCC	Weekly	One day
Structure of BCC interest rates	BCC	Monthly	One week
Consumer price index	BCC	Weekly	One week
Retail banks' financial soundness indicators	BCC	Monthly	2 weeks
Commodity exports (value and volume), imports (value and volume) and domestic production indicators	BCC	Monthly	3 weeks
Implementation of the BCC foreign exchange cash flow plan	BCC	Weekly	1 week

Summary of Data to be Reported (Concluded)

Information	Responsible entity	Frequency	Reporting deadline
Implementation of the BCC domestic currency cash flow plan	BCC	Monthly	1 week
Amounts and holders of promissory notes (bills) guaranteed by the BCC	BCC	Monthly	3 weeks
Evolution of Commitment Plan and Treasury Plan Implementation	MF/MB	Weekly	One day
Implementation of the government cash flow plan	MF	Monthly	2 weeks
Amount, terms, holders, and stock of promissory notes (bills)	MF/BCC	Monthly	3 weeks
Breakdown of customs and excise revenues	MF	Monthly	4 weeks
Breakdown of direct and indirect taxes	MF	Monthly	4 weeks
Breakdown of nontax revenues	MF	Monthly	4 weeks
Projected expenditure commitment schedule	MB	Quarterly	2 weeks
Budgetary monitoring statement (ESB)	MB	Monthly	2 weeks
Approved wage bill by type of beneficiary	MF	Monthly	3 weeks
Wage bill paid by type of beneficiary	MF	Monthly	3 weeks
Compensated employees by category	MF	Monthly	3 weeks
Civil service wage scale	MF	In the event of change	3 weeks
Amounts of emergency spending, amounts approved by the emergency spending committee, amounts adjusted and paid by the BCC	MF/BCC	Monthly	3 weeks
Privatization receipts	MF/BCC	Monthly	3 weeks
Public sector domestic debt by category and by creditor	MF	Monthly	3 weeks
Loan contracts for any new external debt contracted or guaranteed by the central government, the BCC and local governments	MF/BCC	Monthly	3 weeks
Budget execution monitoring table showing Annual Treasury and Commitment Plans and all stages of expenditure execution through payments.	MF/MB	Weekly	3 days
Price Waterhouse Coopers audit reports, indicating any adjustments made to data reported at test dates	BCC		1 week

Annex

Definition of debt

Debt is defined as direct, and therefore unconditional obligation created under a contractual agreement providing for the provision of value in the form of assets (including monetary) or services, which requires the debtor to make one or more payments in the form of assets (including monetary) or to provide services on one or more future dates; these payments discharge the principal and interest liabilities incurred by the debtor under the contract. Debt can take a number of forms, including: (i) loans, that is, advances of funds to the debtor by the creditor on the basis of an undertaking that the debtor will repay the funds in the future (including deposits, bonds, debentures, commercial loans, and buyers' credits) and temporary exchanges of assets that are equivalent to fully collateralized loans, under which the debtor is required to repay the loaned funds and usually pay interest, by repurchasing in the future the assets given as collateral to the seller (for example, repurchase agreements or official swap arrangements); (ii) suppliers' credits, that is, contracts whereby the supplier permits the customer to defer payment until sometime after the date on which the goods are delivered or the services are provided; and (iii) leases, that is, arrangements giving the lessee the right to use a property for periods of time that are usually shorter than the useful life of the property in question, but without transferring ownership, title to which is retained by the lessor. For the purposes of this directive, the debt is the present value (at the inception of the lease) of all lease payments expected to be made during the term of the arrangement, excluding payments covering the operation, repair, and maintenance of the properties in question.

Under the definition of debt set out above, arrears, penalties, and court-awarded damages arising from a failure to make payment under a contractual obligation having the character of debt also constitute debt. Failure to make payment on an obligation that is not considered debt under this definition (e.g., payment on delivery) will not give rise to debt.



INTERNATIONAL MONETARY FUND

Public Information Notice

EXTERNAL
RELATIONS
DEPARTMENT

APPENDIX II—DRAFT PUBLIC INFORMATION NOTICE

Public Information Notice (PIN) No. 09/xx
FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE
[12/11/09]

International Monetary Fund
700 19th Street, NW
Washington, D. C. 20431 USA

**IMF Executive Board Concludes Article IV Consultation with the
Democratic Republic of the Congo**

On December [11], the Executive Board of the International Monetary Fund (IMF) concluded the Article IV consultation with the Democratic Republic of the Congo.¹

Background

The DRC has made considerable progress on the social, political and economic fronts since 2001. In 2003–06, a transitional government implemented prudent macroeconomic policies that restored confidence and brought hyperinflation under control. These and structural reforms to make the economy more flexible supported an economic recovery. On the political front, the country held its first democratic elections in four decades that led to the installation of a broad-based government in early 2007.

However, the pace of economic reforms proved difficult to sustain. In 2007, the onset of elections, lingering conflict in the country's eastern provinces, and weak public financial management led to significant fiscal slippages, resulting in an upsurge in inflation and exchange depreciation. Although the firming of commodity export prices helped strong recovery of the mining sector and supported robust economic growth, full economic recovery from years of conflict continued to be constrained by dilapidated infrastructure and weak regulatory environment.

¹ Under Article IV of the IMF's Articles of Agreement, the IMF holds bilateral discussions with members, usually every year. A staff team visits the country, collects economic and financial information, and discusses with officials the country's economic developments and policies. On return to headquarters, the staff prepares a report, which forms the basis for discussion by the Executive Board. At the conclusion of the discussion, the Managing Director, as Chairman of the Board, summarizes the views of Executive Directors, and this summary is transmitted to the country's authorities.

In 2008, economic conditions were complicated by the onset of the global financial crisis and lingering conflict in the eastern provinces. Significant drop in the country's terms of trade following the global financial crisis and supply bottlenecks (especially shortages in cement and electricity) limited real GDP growth to 6 percent instead of a projected 10 percent. An acceleration of security-related spending late in the year in the context of weak public financial management led also to fiscal slippages. This resulted in a significant increase in government recourse to central bank financing, an increase in excess liquidity in the economy, and upsurge in inflation and exchange rate depreciation. The 2008 current account deficit widened by 14½ percentage points of GDP to about 16 percent of GDP on the back of buoyant imports and decline in export prices in the second half of 2008. Gross official reserves reached a historically low level of US\$30 million by February 2009, down from US\$180 million at end-2007.

In response, macroeconomic policies were tightened during 2009. The government tightened fiscal policy and reduced the fiscal deficit. Further, the central bank raised its rediscount rate in two steps from 40 percent to 65 percent and stepped up sales of central bank bills. Nevertheless, lack of adequate coordination between the central bank and the Treasury in the third quarter of 2009 led to an increase in excess liquidity in the economy. Under these circumstances, year-on-year inflation, which declined from 55 percent in April to 36 percent in June, rose to 53 percent in October. However, official gross international reserves increased to US\$894 at end-September 2009 due to the disbursement of emergency assistance from the Fund and other development partners, the arrival of the first tranche of the signing bonus of the Sino-Congolese Cooperation Agreement, and the general and special SDR allocation (SDR 424.5 million). Economic growth is estimated at 2.7 percent in 2009. The external current is estimated to have widened to 16.4 percent of GDP, in view of weaker export commodity prices.

The Democratic Republic of the Congo remains in debt distress. The stock of external debt is about US\$13.1 billion with debt service. At end 2008, the present value of public and publicly guaranteed external debt is estimated at 93 percent of GDP, 150 percent of exports, and 502 percent of government revenue (excluding grants), well above the policy-based threshold levels. In addition to prudent policies and reforms, attaining debt sustainability hinges on the country receiving debt relief under the enhanced Highly Indebted Poor Country Initiative and Multilateral Debt Relief Initiative. In this context, the authorities have revised with their counterparts the Sino-Congolese Cooperation agreement to make it consistent with the objective of achieving debt sustainability while addressing the country's infrastructure gap.

Executive Board Assessment

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Public Information Notices (PINs) form part of the IMF's efforts to promote transparency of the IMF's views and analysis of economic developments and policies. With the consent of the country (or countries) concerned, PINs are issued after Executive Board discussions of Article IV consultations with member countries, of its surveillance of developments at the regional level, of post-program monitoring, and of ex post assessments of member countries with longer-term program engagements. PINs are also issued after Executive Board discussions of general policy matters, unless otherwise decided by the Executive Board in a particular case.

Democratic Republic of the Congo: Selected Economic Indicators, 2005–09

	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009
				Prel.	Proj.
	(Annual percentage change)				
GDP and prices					
Real GDP	7.9	5.6	6.3	6.2	2.7
Consumer prices, end-of-period	21.3	18.2	10.0	27.6	48.7
	(Percent of GDP; unless otherwise indicated)				
Central government finance					
Total government revenue	11.3	12.9	14.8	18.5	18.0
Total government expenditure	20.3	20.4	18.8	22.7	29.1
Overall fiscal balance (payment order basis, incl. grants)	-3.8	0.4	-2.5	-2.3	-3.2
Overall fiscal balance (cash basis, incl. grants)	-10.2	0.3	-3.1	-3.1	-4.8
Balance of payments					
Exports of goods and services	33.4	37.8	65.5	61.3	41.8
Import of goods and services	44.9	42.6	68.9	76.4	66.4
Current account balance, incl. transfers	-10.8	-2.1	-1.5	-15.9	-16.4
Gross official reserves (weeks of nonaid-related imports of goods and services)	2.5	1.5	1.5	1.0	9.9

Sources: Congolese authorities; and IMF staff estimates.